



20 Amazing Children's Bible Stories

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*With Colorful Illustrations, Moral Lessons
& Tigrigna Translations*

Written & Illustrated by
Daniel Tesfamariam

A Gift of Faith for Children Everywhere

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"Train up a child in the way he should go; even when he is old he will not depart from it."

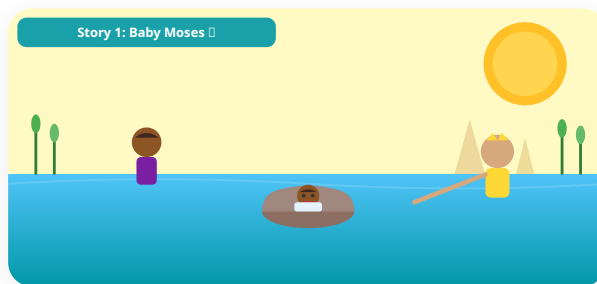
— Proverbs 22:6 | □□□ 22:6

1

📖 Baby Moses in the Basket

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📖 Exodus 1-2 | 📖 📖 📖 1-2



Scene 1 of 25

Long, long ago, in the ancient land of **Egypt**, the people of Israel — God's chosen people — lived as slaves. They worked under the blazing sun, making bricks of mud and straw, building great cities for the cruel **Pharaoh**. But even in suffering, the Israelites grew in number, and this frightened the king greatly.

□ **PICTURE:** Ancient Egypt with pyramids in background. Israelite slaves making mud bricks under harsh sun. East African/Eritrean features on the workers. Taskmasters with whips watching. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration. Dusty golden light.

Scene 2 of 25

Pharaoh was afraid. *"These Israelites are becoming too many! What if they rise against us?"* he said with an angry face. So he made a terrible, wicked command: *"Every baby boy born to the Hebrews must be thrown into the Nile River!"* The mothers wept. The fathers trembled. Darkness fell over Israel.

□ **PICTURE:** Pharaoh on golden throne, angry expression, pointing finger giving evil decree. Egyptian soldiers standing around. Dark shadows. Palace with hieroglyphics. Dramatic watercolor illustration. Fearful Israelite women in background covering their mouths.

Scene 3 of 25

But in the village of the Levites, there lived a faithful woman named **Jochebed** and her husband **Amram**. They already had two children — a daughter named **Miriam** and a son named **Aaron**. And now, Jochebed was expecting another baby. She prayed every night: *"Lord, protect my child."*

□ **PICTURE:** *A humble Israelite home made of mud brick. A pregnant East African/Eritrean woman (Jochebed) praying with hands raised, wearing traditional white netela cloth. Husband beside her. Two children (Miriam age 12, Aaron age 3) sleeping nearby. Warm candlelight. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

One beautiful night, under the bright stars of Egypt, the baby was born — a perfect, beautiful **boy**! Jochebed held him close and wept with joy and fear. He had big brown eyes and a smile that lit up the room. She whispered, *"God has given me a special child. I will not let Pharaoh take him."*

□ **PICTURE:** *Jochebed holding newborn baby tenderly to her chest. East African/Eritrean features. Baby wrapped in white cloth. Starlight coming through small window. Tears of joy on mother's face. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration. Intimate, emotional scene.*

Scene 5 of 25

For **three whole months**, Jochebed hid her baby. Every time Egyptian soldiers marched past their door, the family held their breath. Miriam would sing softly to keep the baby quiet. Aaron would stand by the window watching for danger. The whole family worked together to protect this precious child.

□ **PICTURE:** *Inside humble home, family hiding baby. Jochebed covering baby's mouth gently. Miriam (12-year-old girl with braids) singing softly. Aaron (toddler) peeking through window nervously. Egyptian soldiers' shadows visible outside door. Tense atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 6 of 25

But the baby grew bigger and his cries grew louder! Jochebed knew she couldn't hide him any longer. Neighbors might hear. Soldiers might come. Her heart was breaking, but she had a plan — a brave, faith-filled plan that only a mother's love could create. She called Miriam to help her.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jochebed with worried but determined face, gathering papyrus reeds and tar/pitch. Miriam helping her mother. Baby crying in background. Nile River visible through doorway. Early morning light. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 7 of 25

With trembling but skilled hands, Jochebed wove a **basket from papyrus reeds** — strong and tight. She coated it with **tar and pitch** to make it waterproof. She lined it with the softest cloth she had. It was like a tiny boat — a little ark, just like Noah's ark! A vessel of faith floating on hope.

□ **PICTURE:** Close-up of Jochebed's hands weaving a papyrus basket. Tar and pitch nearby. Basket taking shape — oval, boat-like. Soft white linen cloth for lining. East African/Eritrean woman's hands, detailed craftsmanship. Warm golden light. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 8 of 25

At dawn, before the sun rose high, Jochebed kissed her baby one last time. Tears rolled down her cheeks as she gently placed him in the basket. She wrapped him snugly in soft white linen. *"God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob,"* she prayed, *"hold my son in Your hands. I trust You with his life."*

□ **PICTURE:** Emotional scene: Jochebed kissing baby's forehead, tears streaming. Placing baby into the papyrus basket. Baby looking up at mother with innocent eyes. Dawn light, soft pink and gold sky visible. East African/Eritrean mother. Deep emotion. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 9 of 25

Silently, through the misty morning, Jochebed carried the basket to the great **Nile River**. The water was calm. Tall papyrus reeds grew along the bank, creating a hidden shelter. She placed the basket gently among the reeds, where the current was soft. The baby slept peacefully, rocked by the gentle waves.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jochebed at riverbank, placing basket among tall papyrus reeds in the Nile. Misty morning. River calm and beautiful. Basket floating gently. Baby sleeping inside. Lotus flowers nearby. Birds on reeds. Soft watercolor palette. East African/Eritrean woman. Children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 10 of 25

Brave young **Miriam** — only twelve years old — hid herself among the reeds at a distance. Her mother had given her an important mission: *"Watch over your brother. See what happens to him."* Miriam's heart pounded, but she was brave. She would not leave her baby brother alone.

□ **PICTURE:** *Young Miriam (12 years old, East African/Eritrean girl with braided hair) hiding behind tall papyrus reeds, watching the basket from a distance. Determined, brave expression. Peeking carefully. River scene, morning light. Dragonflies around. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 11 of 25

The morning sun climbed higher. Miriam waited. Then she heard voices — female voices, laughing and talking. A group of women appeared on the path leading to the river. In the center walked a beautiful, richly dressed woman — it was **Pharaoh's own daughter**, the princess of Egypt! She had come to bathe in the Nile.

□ **PICTURE:** *Egyptian princess (Pharaoh's daughter) walking toward the Nile with her handmaidens. Richly dressed in Egyptian royal clothing — gold jewelry, white linen dress, elaborate headdress. Handmaidens carrying towels and oils. Lush riverbank scene. Elegant watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 12 of 25

As the princess walked along the river's edge, something caught her eye — a strange basket nestled among the reeds! *"What is that?"* she said, pointing. *"Bring it to me!"* she commanded her maidservant. The servant waded into the shallow water and carefully brought the basket to the princess.

□ **PICTURE:** *Egyptian princess pointing at basket in reeds with surprised expression. Handmaiden wading into shallow water to retrieve it. Other servants watching curiously. Basket visible among green papyrus. Beautiful Nile riverbank. Watercolor children's Bible illustration. Sunlight sparkling on water.*

Scene 13 of 25

The princess opened the basket — and there lay the most beautiful baby boy she had ever seen! At that moment, the baby opened his eyes and began to **cry**. The princess's heart melted instantly. *"Oh! This is one of the Hebrew babies,"* she said softly. But instead of anger, her eyes filled with **compassion**.

□ **PICTURE:** Close-up: Egyptian princess opening the basket, looking down with compassion and wonder. Baby Moses inside, crying, reaching up. Princess's face showing love and pity. Gold jewelry catching light. Tender, emotional moment. Watercolor children's Bible illustration. Warm golden tones.

Scene 14 of 25

Miriam watched everything from her hiding place. Her heart was racing! When she saw the princess holding her brother with tenderness, Miriam knew this was her moment. With incredible bravery for a young girl, she stepped out from behind the reeds and approached the royal princess of Egypt.

□ **PICTURE:** Miriam stepping out bravely from behind papyrus reeds, approaching the Egyptian princess and her servants. Small girl facing royalty. Contrast between simple Hebrew clothing and Egyptian finery. Brave expression on Miriam's face. River setting. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 15 of 25

Miriam bowed respectfully and spoke with a voice that was both nervous and clever: *"Shall I go and find one of the Hebrew women to nurse the baby for you?"* The princess looked at this brave little girl and smiled. *"Yes, go!"* she said. Miriam's plan had worked! She ran as fast as her legs could carry her.

□ **PICTURE:** *Miriam bowing before the Egyptian princess, speaking up boldly. Princess sitting with baby in arms, smiling and nodding. Handmaidens watching impressed. Then Miriam running joyfully away. Split scene showing both moments. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 16 of 25

Miriam ran straight home! *"Mama! Mama! Come quickly!"* she cried breathlessly. *"The princess found him — and she wants a Hebrew woman to nurse him! You can take care of your own baby — and you'll even be PAID for it!"* Jochebed's tears of fear became tears of **joy and gratitude** to God!

□ **PICTURE:** *Miriam bursting through the door of their humble home, breathless and excited. Jochebed turning around with shock then joy. Tears of happiness. Aaron watching. Domestic scene with cooking pot and simple furniture. East African/Eritrean family. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 17 of 25

Jochebed hurried to the river. When she appeared before the princess, she bowed low. The princess placed the baby in Jochebed's arms — **her own baby!** — and said, *"Take this child and nurse him for me, and I will pay you."* Jochebed held her son close, her heart overflowing. God had answered her prayer in the most miraculous way!

□ **PICTURE:** *Princess handing baby back to Jochebed (his own mother!). Jochebed receiving baby with tears of joy, trying to stay composed. Princess handing her gold coins for payment. Miraculous, beautiful moment. Both women showing kindness. By the Nile River. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

So baby Moses went home with his own mother! For the next few years, Jochebed nursed him, sang to him, and most importantly — she taught him about the **one true God**. She told him about Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. She planted seeds of faith in his little heart that would grow into a mighty tree.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jochebed at home with baby Moses on her lap, teaching him. Telling stories by candlelight. Miriam and Aaron listening too. Warm, loving family scene. East African/Eritrean family features. Simple but happy home. Stars visible through window. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

When Moses was old enough, the hardest day came — Jochebed had to bring him to the palace to live with the princess as her adopted son. Jochebed knelt before the little boy: *"Always remember, my son — you are a child of Israel. The Lord your God will be with you wherever you go."* She kissed him goodbye.

□ **PICTURE:** Emotional farewell: Jochebed kneeling, holding young Moses (about 4 years old) tightly. Tears streaming. Egyptian palace visible in background. Miriam and Aaron watching sadly. Young Moses looking confused but brave. Golden sunset light. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 20 of 25

The princess named the boy **Moses**, which means "*I drew him out of the water.*" In the palace, young Moses was given the finest education — he learned reading, writing, mathematics, and the wisdom of Egypt. He wore royal clothes and ate royal food. But in his heart, he never forgot his mother's words about God.

□ **PICTURE:** Young Moses (now about 8 years old) in Egyptian royal clothing, being educated in the palace. Scrolls, tutors, and luxury around him. But his face shows he's thinking deeply — remembering his Hebrew family. Grand Egyptian palace interior with columns and paintings. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 21 of 25

Years passed. Moses grew into a strong young man — a prince of Egypt with all its privileges. But when he saw his Hebrew brothers suffering as slaves, his heart burned with pain. He knew he was one of *them*, not one of the Egyptians. God was preparing Moses for something far greater than being a prince.

□ **PICTURE:** *Adult Moses in Egyptian prince clothing, looking out from palace balcony at Hebrew slaves working below. Conflicted expression — anger at injustice and compassion for his people. Contrast between luxury above and suffering below. Dramatic lighting. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

God had a **mighty plan** for this baby who was once floating in a basket. One day, from a burning bush in the desert, God would call Moses: *"I have seen the suffering of My people. I am sending YOU to set them free!"* The baby in the basket would become the greatest leader Israel ever knew!

□ **PICTURE:** *Split scene: Left side shows baby in basket on the Nile. Right side shows adult Moses before the burning bush in the desert, kneeling in awe. God's light shining from the bush. Connection between the two moments. Dramatic, prophetic atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 23 of 25

Moses would lead over **two million people** out of slavery! He would part the Red Sea, receive the Ten Commandments from God on Mount Sinai, and guide Israel for 40 years through the wilderness. All because one brave mother trusted God, one sister watched with courage, and one princess showed mercy.

Scene 24 of 25 — ⏮ ⏪ ⏴ ⏵ ⏭ ⏸ ⏮ ⏪ ⏴ ⏵ ⏭ ⏸ | In Tigrigna

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□ **Moral Lesson** | □□□□□ □□□□

Key Virtues: Faith, Courage, Trust in God, Family Love, Obedience

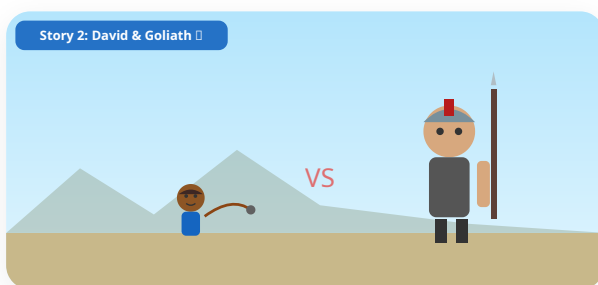
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2

David and Goliath

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□ 1 Samuel 17 | 1 □□□□ 17



Scene 1 of 25

In the green hills of **Bethlehem**, a young shepherd boy named **David** tended his father's sheep. He was the youngest of eight brothers — small in size, but mighty in spirit. While others saw just a boy, God saw a future king. David's days were spent under open skies, singing songs of praise to the Lord.

□ **PICTURE:** *Young David (about 14 years old) sitting on a hillside with sheep grazing around him. Playing a small harp/lyre. East African/Eritrean features, curly hair. Green rolling hills of Bethlehem. Blue sky with fluffy clouds. Peaceful, pastoral scene. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 2 of 25

David was no ordinary shepherd. One day, a **lion** crept toward his flock and snatched a lamb! David didn't run — he chased the lion, struck it, and rescued the lamb from its mouth! Another time, a **bear** attacked. David fought it too and won! *"The Lord who saved me from the lion and the bear will save me,"* David said.

□ **PICTURE:** *Dynamic action scene: Young David wrestling a lion, pulling a lamb from its jaws. Muscular but young boy showing incredible bravery. Lion roaring. Sheep scattered in background. Dramatic lighting. East African/Eritrean boy. Powerful watercolor children's Bible illustration. Energy and movement.*

Scene 3 of 25

Far away, the armies of **Israel** and the **Philistines** faced each other across a valley. The Israelite soldiers stood on one hill, the Philistines on another. For forty days, the two armies had been stuck — too afraid to fight. And the reason was one terrifying man.

□ **PICTURE:** *Wide landscape: Valley of Elah between two hills. Israeli army camp on one side (tents, soldiers with spears). Philistine army on the other. Tension in the air. No one moving. Overcast sky creating ominous mood. Panoramic watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

Every morning and every evening, a **giant** warrior stomped into the valley. His name was **GOLIATH**. He was over **nine feet tall** — taller than any man alive! His armor weighed 125 pounds. His spear was like a tree trunk. The ground shook with each step. His voice thundered across the valley like an earthquake.

□ **PICTURE:** *Massive Goliath standing in the valley, towering over everything. Full bronze armor gleaming, enormous spear, shield bearer before him. Menacing, terrifying figure against stormy sky. Exaggerated size to show how enormous he was. Dark, intimidating atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 5 of 25

Goliath's voice boomed: *"Choose a man to fight me! If he kills me, we will be your servants. But if I kill him, you will serve us!"* He laughed a terrible laugh. *"I defy the armies of Israel! Give me a man to fight!"* Every single Israelite soldier trembled. King Saul himself was terrified. No one dared to answer.

□ **PICTURE:** Goliath shouting challenge with mouth wide open, fist raised. Israeli soldiers cowering, hiding behind shields, looking terrified. King Saul in his tent, face pale with fear. Echo effect showing his voice carrying. Dark dramatic clouds. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 6 of 25

One day, David's father Jesse said, *"David, take this bread and cheese to your brothers in the army camp. See how they are doing."* David left his sheep with another keeper and walked the long road to the Valley of Elah, carrying food for his three oldest brothers who were soldiers.

□ **PICTURE:** David walking on a dusty path carrying a basket of bread and cheese. Determined young boy on a journey. Bethlehem hills behind him, army camp visible in the distance ahead. Morning light. Simple shepherd's clothing. East African/Eritrean boy. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 7 of 25

When David arrived at the camp and found his brothers, suddenly the earth seemed to shake. **BOOM. BOOM. BOOM.** Goliath was coming out for his daily challenge! David watched as every soldier around him dropped their weapons and ran backward in fear. But David didn't run. He stood still, watching, listening.

□ **PICTURE:** David in the army camp, soldiers fleeing past him in terror. David standing firm, looking toward the valley. Goliath's massive silhouette visible in

the distance. Contrast between fleeing soldiers and small brave boy standing still. Dust and chaos. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 8 of 25

David's face burned with holy anger. *"Who is this uncircumcised Philistine that he dares to defy the armies of the LIVING GOD?"* he asked boldly. His brothers were embarrassed. *"Go home, little boy! You're just a shepherd!"* Eliab, his oldest brother, snapped. But David would not be silenced. God was stirring his heart.

□ **PICTURE:** *David speaking boldly to soldiers, pointing toward Goliath in distance. His older brother Eliab angry, grabbing David's shoulder trying to silence him. Other soldiers looking surprised at the boy's courage. Camp setting with tents. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

Word reached **King Saul** that a boy wanted to fight Goliath! David was brought before the king. Saul looked at this small, young shepherd and said, *"You can't fight this giant! You're just a boy, and he's been a warrior since his youth!"* But David answered with faith blazing in his eyes.

□ **PICTURE:** *Young David standing before King Saul in the royal tent. Saul is tall, in armor, looking down doubtfully at the small boy. David looking up with*

confidence and fire in his eyes. Royal tent with lamps and weapons on stands. Size contrast between king and boy. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 10 of 25

"Your Majesty," David said, "when a lion and a bear came after my sheep, the LORD helped me kill them both. This Philistine will be like one of them — because he has defied the army of the living God! The LORD who delivered me from the lion and the bear will deliver me from this giant!"

□ **PICTURE:** David speaking passionately to King Saul, gesturing with hands, telling his story. Vision/memory bubbles showing lion and bear above his head. Saul's expression changing from doubt to amazement. Advisors in background listening. Dramatic lamplight. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 11 of 25

King Saul was amazed by David's faith. *"Go! And the LORD be with you,"* he said. Saul tried to give David his own heavy armor — a bronze helmet, a coat of mail, a great sword. David put them on but couldn't even walk! *"I can't use these,"* he said, taking them off. *"I'm not used to them."*

□ **PICTURE:** Humorous scene: Small David wearing Saul's enormous armor that's way too big for him. Helmet falling over his eyes, armor dragging on

ground. Trying to walk but stumbling. Saul and soldiers watching. Then David removing the armor. Comedy and humility. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 12 of 25

Instead, David picked up his simple **shepherd's staff**, went to a nearby stream, and carefully chose **five smooth stones**. He placed them in his leather shepherd's bag. In his hand he held his sling — the same sling he'd used a thousand times protecting his sheep. This was all he needed. This, and his God.

□ **PICTURE:** *David kneeling by a clear stream, carefully selecting five smooth stones from the water. His sling and staff beside him. Putting stones in his leather pouch. Focused, prayerful expression. Stream water sparkling. Simple but powerful moment. East African/Eritrean boy. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 13 of 25

David walked into the valley. Alone. No armor. No sword. Just a staff, a sling, and five stones. The entire army of Israel watched in shock. The Philistines pointed and laughed. And Goliath... Goliath saw David coming and his face twisted with rage and insult.

□ **PICTURE:** *Wide valley shot: Tiny David walking alone into the vast open valley between two armies. Thousands of soldiers on both hillsides watching. Goliath's massive figure waiting at the other end. David looks incredibly small*

but walks with purpose. Epic, cinematic composition. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 14 of 25

Goliath looked at David and sneered with disgust: *"Am I a DOG that you come at me with sticks?! Come here, boy, and I will feed your flesh to the birds and wild beasts!"* He cursed David by his gods. The giant's mocking laughter echoed through the valley. Every heart in Israel sank. But not David's.

□ **PICTURE:** *Goliath towering over approaching David, face full of contempt and mockery. Pointing down at the small boy. Mouth open shouting insults. Birds circling overhead. Dark sky behind Goliath. David approaching from lower perspective — small but undaunted. Dramatic confrontation. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 15 of 25

David shouted back with a voice full of holy power: *"You come against me with sword and spear and javelin — but I come against you in the NAME of the LORD Almighty, the God of the armies of Israel whom you have defied! This day the LORD will deliver you into MY hands!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *David standing boldly, arm raised, shouting his declaration of faith toward Goliath. Wind blowing his hair back. Light seeming to shine behind him. Small boy making a giant statement. Words seem to carry power.*

Both armies hearing. Heroic, faith-filled moment. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 16 of 25

Goliath roared and charged forward, his massive feet pounding the earth like thunder! David didn't retreat — he **ran toward the giant!** As he ran, his hand reached into his bag, pulled out one smooth stone, loaded it into his sling, and began swinging it faster and faster above his head.

□ **PICTURE:** *Intense action: David running TOWARD Goliath (not away!). Sling spinning above his head in a blur. Goliath charging from the opposite direction, spear raised. Both running at each other. Dust flying. Incredible tension and movement. Dynamic composition. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 17 of 25

David released the stone! It flew through the air like a bullet guided by God's own hand. **CRACK!** The stone struck Goliath right in the center of his forehead — the one spot not covered by his helmet! The giant's eyes went wide. His enormous body swayed... then like a great tree cut at its base, Goliath **fell face-down** on the ground!

□ **PICTURE:** *The climactic moment: Stone flying through the air (motion blur) and striking Goliath's forehead. Goliath's eyes wide with shock. Beginning to*

fall forward. Dust clouds rising. Divine light behind the stone's path. Time seems frozen. Both armies watching in disbelief. Epic watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 18 of 25

BOOM! The earth shook as the giant hit the ground! Dust billowed up like a cloud. There was a moment of pure silence — then the army of Israel erupted in the greatest shout of victory! *"The Lord has won! David has defeated Goliath!"* The Philistines turned and fled in absolute terror!

❑ **PICTURE:** *Goliath crashed face-down on the ground, massive and defeated. David standing over him victoriously. Israeli army on hillside jumping, cheering, raising weapons in celebration. Philistine army fleeing in panic. Sun breaking through clouds like God's approval. Triumphant watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

David ran and stood over the fallen giant. He took Goliath's own sword and held it high! The boy who came with a sling and stones had defeated the mightiest warrior in the world — not by might, not by power, but by the **Spirit of the Lord**! Israel was saved! God had proven that no giant is too big for Him.

□ **PICTURE:** *David standing on top of fallen Goliath, holding the giant's enormous sword above his head in victory. Light streaming down from heaven onto David. Crowd rushing down hillside toward him. Joy and celebration everywhere. Heroic pose. Young East African/Eritrean boy victorious. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 20 of 25

The Israeli soldiers chased the Philistines all the way back to their cities! That day, Israel won a great victory. David was brought before King Saul as a hero. The women of Israel sang and danced: "*Saul has slain his thousands, and David his ten thousands!*" The shepherd boy was on his way to becoming king.

□ **PICTURE:** *Victory celebration: Women dancing with tambourines, children cheering, soldiers lifting David on their shoulders. Joyful procession back to camp. Colorful garments, flowers being thrown. Music and celebration. East African/Eritrean people celebrating. Festive watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 21 of 25

But David's story didn't end there. This boy who trusted God against a giant would grow up to become **King David** — the greatest king Israel ever had! He wrote many of the Psalms we sing today. And from his family line, many generations later, Jesus Christ Himself

would be born — the ultimate Giant-Slayer who defeats sin and death!

□ **PICTURE:** *Split scene showing David's journey: shepherd boy with harp □ warrior with sling □ crowned King on throne □ and a shining star above Bethlehem (pointing to Jesus). Growth and progression. Golden royal light. Destiny unfolding. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

What made David different? It wasn't his size — he was the smallest. It wasn't his weapons — he had none. It wasn't his experience — he was just a boy. It was his **FAITH**. David believed that God was bigger than any problem, stronger than any enemy, and faithful to His promises. That faith made all the difference.

□ **PICTURE:** *Artistic/symbolic image: Small David silhouette standing against a massive shadow of Goliath, but David is filled with golden light (representing God's presence). The light from David is larger than Goliath's shadow. Visual metaphor of faith overcoming fear. Beautiful watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 23 of 25

David later wrote in Psalm 27: *"The Lord is my light and my salvation — whom shall I fear? The Lord is the stronghold of my life — of whom shall I*

With God, even the smallest person can defeat the biggest giant. David was young, small, and had no weapons — but his faith in God was bigger than Goliath! Whatever "giants" you face in life — fear, bullying, sickness, problems at school — remember that God is with you. You are NEVER too small for God to use!

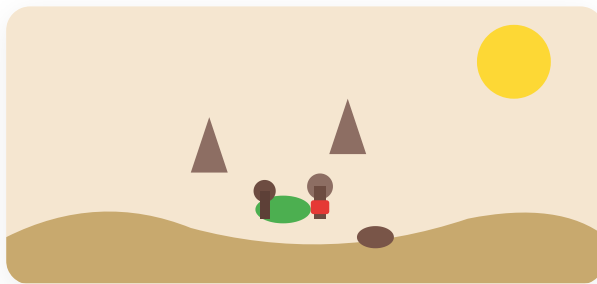
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3

▯ The Good Samaritan

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▯ Luke 10:25-37 | ▯▯▯ 10:25-37



Scene 1 of 25

One bright, sunny day in the land of Israel, **Jesus** was teaching a large crowd of people. Men, women, and children gathered around Him, eager to hear His wise words. Among the crowd was a **lawyer** — a man who studied God's laws very carefully and thought he knew all the answers. This lawyer stood up proudly, wanting to test Jesus with a tricky question. He puffed out his chest and asked in a loud voice, *"Teacher, what must I do to receive eternal life?"*

□ **PICTURE:** *A crowd of people with East African/Eritrean features gathered on a sunny hillside, sitting on green grass. Jesus stands at center in white and blue robes, hands open in teaching gesture. A proud-looking lawyer in fine robes stands up from the crowd, finger raised questioningly. Warm golden sunlight, watercolor children's Bible illustration style with soft edges and gentle colors.*

Scene 2 of 25

Jesus looked at the lawyer with kind, knowing eyes and smiled gently. Instead of answering directly, Jesus asked him back, *"What is written in the Law? How do you read it?"* The lawyer answered quickly and confidently, reciting the words he had memorized since childhood: *"Love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your strength, and with all your mind — and love your neighbor as yourself."* Jesus nodded approvingly and said, **"You have answered correctly. Do this and you will live."**

□ **PICTURE:** *Close-up of Jesus with warm brown skin and East African features, wearing white robes, smiling kindly at a well-dressed lawyer. The lawyer gestures as he recites scripture, looking confident. Background shows other listeners watching intently. Soft watercolor style with warm golden tones, children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 3 of 25

But the lawyer was not satisfied. He wanted to **justify himself** — to prove that he was already good enough and didn't need to change. So he asked another question, trying to find a loophole: "*And who is my neighbor?*" He thought perhaps "neighbor" only meant people from his own town, his own people, his own religion. Surely he didn't have to love *everyone*? Jesus saw straight into his heart, and instead of giving a simple answer, He decided to tell a **story** — a parable that would change the lawyer's understanding forever.

□ **PICTURE:** *The lawyer with East African/Eritrean features looking skeptical, arms crossed, eyebrow raised as he asks "who is my neighbor?" Jesus seated on a rock, about to tell a story, with a gentle knowing expression. Other listeners lean forward in anticipation. Watercolor children's Bible illustration, warm earth tones, dappled sunlight filtering through olive trees.*

Scene 4 of 25

Jesus began His story: "*A certain man was traveling down the road from Jerusalem to Jericho.*" This was a very dangerous road — everyone knew it! It was a long, winding path that went through rocky desert hills and deep valleys. Robbers and thieves loved to hide behind the big rocks along this lonely road, waiting for travelers to pass by. The road dropped steeply — over 3,000 feet in just 17 miles! People called it the "**Way of Blood**" because so many travelers had been attacked there.

□ **PICTURE:** *A winding dusty road descending through rocky desert hills and deep valleys. Large boulders and caves line the path. A lone traveler with East African/Eritrean features in simple robes walks along the dangerous road,*

looking cautious. Harsh shadows from cliffs above. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dusty ochre and brown tones with hints of danger in dark shadows.

Scene 5 of 25

Suddenly, from behind the large rocks, **robbers** jumped out! There were several of them — rough, cruel men with angry faces. They grabbed the poor traveler before he could run or call for help. They punched him and kicked him and threw him to the ground. They tore off his clothes, taking everything he had — his money, his bag, his sandals, even his cloak. They beat him terribly, leaving him **half dead** on the side of the road, bleeding and unable to move. Then they ran away, disappearing into the rocky hills like shadows.

▮ **PICTURE:** *Dramatic scene of robbers with covered faces attacking a traveler on a rocky desert road. The traveler with East African features falls to the ground as three robbers grab his belongings. Dust flies in the air. Dark threatening shadows contrast with bright desert sky. Watercolor children's Bible illustration, action and movement captured in brushstrokes, warm but tense atmosphere.*

Scene 6 of 25

The poor man lay on the dusty road, barely alive. His body was covered in bruises and cuts. Blood trickled from wounds on his head and arms. He could not stand up. He could barely open his eyes.

Every breath hurt. He lay there under the hot sun, desperately hoping that **someone — anyone** — would come along and help him. He was too weak to call out, too hurt to crawl to shade. Flies buzzed around his wounds. Time passed slowly as the sun beat down mercilessly.

□ **PICTURE:** *A wounded man with East African/Eritrean features lying on the dusty roadside, barely conscious. His clothes are torn and he has visible bruises. The hot sun beats down. The road stretches empty in both directions. Small rocks and dried brush surround him. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, muted painful colors but still appropriate for children, conveying vulnerability and need.*

Scene 7 of 25

After some time, the sound of footsteps echoed on the road. A **priest** was coming! A priest was a holy man who served in God's temple — someone who taught people about God's love and mercy. Surely, **surely** this priest would help! The wounded man's heart filled with hope as he heard the footsteps getting closer. The priest was dressed in fine religious robes, walking down from Jerusalem where he had been serving at the temple. He was an important man, a man of God.

□ **PICTURE:** *A priest in ornate religious robes with East African/Eritrean features walking down the dusty road. He carries a staff and wears a turban-like head covering. In the distance on the roadside, the wounded man is visible. The priest's face shows he has noticed the injured man. Watercolor*

children's Bible illustration, warm tones, showing the road curving with rocky hills on either side.

Scene 8 of 25

But when the priest saw the beaten, bleeding man lying on the road, do you know what he did? He did NOT stop to help. Instead, he **crossed to the other side of the road** and hurried past! Perhaps he thought, "If I touch this man, I will become unclean and cannot serve in the temple." Perhaps he was scared the robbers might still be nearby. Perhaps he simply did not want to be bothered. Whatever his excuse, he walked right past the suffering man, pretending he did not see him. The wounded man's hope faded as the priest's footsteps grew distant.

□ **PICTURE:** *The priest with East African features deliberately crossing to the far side of the road, looking away from the wounded man. He holds his robes up to avoid getting dirty, walking quickly. The wounded man reaches out a weak hand toward him. A clear gap between them shows the priest's deliberate avoidance. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm colors with the contrast between the priest's fine robes and the injured man's suffering.*

Scene 9 of 25

A little while later, another set of footsteps approached. This time it was a **Levite** — another religious man who helped with services at

God's temple. Levites were supposed to be examples of kindness and godliness. The wounded man heard the footsteps and felt a spark of hope once more. Surely this man of God would stop and show mercy! The Levite walked closer and closer, and he actually came over and **looked** at the wounded man — he saw his injuries, his pain, his desperate eyes.

□ **PICTURE:** *A Levite with East African/Eritrean features in semi-formal religious attire approaching the wounded man on the road. He bends slightly to look at the injured man with a curious but uncommitted expression. The road stretches behind him. Watercolor children's Bible illustration, warm desert colors, showing the moment of decision as the Levite examines the situation.*

Scene 10 of 25

But the Levite did the same terrible thing as the priest! After looking at the wounded man — after seeing his pain with his very own eyes — he too **passed by on the other side**. He turned away and kept walking, leaving the poor man alone and suffering. Two religious men, two men who were supposed to represent God's love — and both had walked away! The wounded man must have felt so alone, so abandoned. Was there no one in the whole world who would show him kindness?

□ **PICTURE:** *The Levite with East African features walking away from the wounded man, looking back over his shoulder with a conflicted but ultimately indifferent expression. The wounded man lies still on the roadside, alone again. The empty road ahead of the Levite. Watercolor children's Bible*

illustration style, warm but somber tones, emphasizing the loneliness and abandonment felt by the injured traveler.

Scene 11 of 25

Then, clip-clop, clip-clop — the sound of a donkey's hooves on the rocky road. A third traveler was approaching. But this man was a **Samaritan**. Now, the Jewish people and the Samaritans did NOT get along at all! They had been enemies for hundreds of years. Jews thought Samaritans were unclean and wrong. Samaritans felt the same about Jews. They would not eat together, talk together, or even walk on the same side of the road. If anyone had an excuse NOT to help this Jewish man, it was the Samaritan!

□ **PICTURE:** *A Samaritan man with East African/Eritrean features riding a donkey loaded with supplies, coming around a bend in the rocky road. He wears simple but clean traveling clothes with a distinctive head covering. His expression changes from calm travel to concern as he spots something ahead on the road. Watercolor children's Bible illustration, warm earthy colors, the donkey is grey-brown with kind eyes.*

Scene 12 of 25

But when the Samaritan saw the wounded man lying on the road, something beautiful happened. His heart was filled with **compassion** — deep, genuine pity and love. He did not think, "This is my enemy." He did not think, "This is not my problem." He did not worry about

getting dirty or being late. He saw a human being who was suffering, and his heart said, *"I must help him!"* The Samaritan immediately stopped his donkey, jumped down, and rushed to the wounded man's side.

□ **PICTURE:** *The Samaritan with East African features jumping off his donkey with urgency and compassion on his face. He rushes toward the wounded man lying on the road, arms outstretched to help. His face shows deep concern and love. The donkey waits patiently behind. Warm golden light illuminates the scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, emphasizing the warmth and compassion of the moment, vibrant caring colors.*

Scene 13 of 25

The kind Samaritan knelt down beside the wounded man and gently examined his injuries. He opened his travel bag and pulled out **oil and wine** — precious supplies he had brought for his own journey. Carefully, tenderly, he poured soothing oil on the man's wounds to ease the pain, and wine to clean the cuts and prevent infection. The wounded man winced but felt relief as the cool oil touched his burning skin. *"Don't worry, friend,"* the Samaritan whispered softly, *"I'm going to take care of you."*

□ **PICTURE:** *Close-up of the Samaritan with East African/Eritrean features kneeling beside the wounded man, carefully pouring oil from a small flask onto the man's wounds. His face shows tender concentration. A wine skin and cloth bandages are nearby. The wounded man's face shows relief mixed with*

pain. Warm intimate lighting. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style with soft, caring brushstrokes and warm amber tones.

Scene 14 of 25

Next, the Samaritan took strips of clean cloth and carefully **bandaged** each wound. He wrapped the man's injured head gently, bound his cut arms, and covered the scrapes on his legs. He worked patiently and lovingly, treating this stranger — this supposed enemy — as if he were his own brother. He gave the man water to drink from his own water skin. He spoke kind, encouraging words: *"You're going to be alright. I'm here now. You're safe."* Color slowly returned to the injured man's face.

□ **PICTURE:** *The Samaritan with East African features carefully wrapping white cloth bandages around the wounded man's head and arms. The injured man sits up slightly, supported by the Samaritan. Clean white bandages contrast with the dusty road. A water skin is being offered. Both men have warm brown skin. Watercolor children's Bible illustration, gentle caring scene, soft warm colors with white bandage details.*

Scene 15 of 25

Then the Samaritan did something even more amazing. He carefully lifted the wounded man — who was heavy and limp — and placed him on his very own **donkey**. This meant the Samaritan himself would have to walk the rest of the way on foot! He didn't mind. He

held the man steady on the donkey, walking slowly beside him, making sure he wouldn't fall. Step by step, they made their way down the dangerous road together. The Samaritan walked for miles under the hot sun, never once complaining.

□ **PICTURE:** *The Samaritan with East African/Eritrean features walking beside his donkey, one hand steadying the bandaged wounded man who sits on the donkey's back. The road winds downhill through desert terrain. The sun is beginning to lower in the sky, casting long warm shadows. The Samaritan looks tired but determined and caring. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm golden-hour lighting, journey composition.*

Scene 16 of 25

As evening approached, they finally reached an **inn** — a small roadside lodge where travelers could rest. The Samaritan helped the wounded man down from the donkey and carried him inside. He asked the innkeeper for a room and gently laid the man on a soft bed. That night, the Samaritan stayed by the man's side, changing his bandages, giving him food and water, keeping him warm. He did not sleep much himself — he kept watch over this stranger as if watching over his own family member.

□ **PICTURE:** *A simple stone inn with a wooden door and warm lamplight glowing from within. The Samaritan with East African features helps the bandaged man through the doorway. An innkeeper with a lantern holds the door open. The donkey rests tied outside. Evening sky with purple and orange*

sunset colors. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm welcoming atmosphere, cozy golden light from the inn.

Scene 17 of 25

The next morning, the Samaritan had to continue his own journey — he had his own business to attend to, his own family waiting for him. But before leaving, he reached into his pouch and pulled out **two silver coins** — two denarii, which was equal to two full days' wages! He placed them in the innkeeper's hand and said, *"Take care of this man. Give him food, water, clean bandages — whatever he needs. If you spend more than this, I will repay you when I return."*

□ **PICTURE:** *Interior of the inn, morning light streaming through a small window. The Samaritan with East African/Eritrean features hands two silver coins to the innkeeper, who receives them with both hands. In the background, the wounded man rests peacefully on a bed with fresh bandages. Simple but clean room with clay walls. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm morning light, focus on the generous exchange of coins.*

Scene 18 of 25

Think about what the Samaritan did! He didn't just help for a moment — he gave his own **oil, wine, bandages, donkey, time, money, and sleep** for a complete stranger! A stranger who would normally be considered his enemy! He promised to come back and pay even more

if needed. He asked for nothing in return — no thank you, no payment, no reward. His only motivation was **love** — pure, unconditional love for a fellow human being who was hurting.

□ **PICTURE:** *A split composition showing all the things the Samaritan gave: oil flask, wine skin, white bandages, a donkey, silver coins, and a clock representing time — all arranged around the central figure of the caring Samaritan with East African features, hands open in generosity. Hearts float around him. Bright, joyful watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm vibrant colors celebrating generosity.*

Scene 19 of 25

Jesus finished telling the parable and turned to look directly at the lawyer. The crowd was silent, deeply moved by the story. Then Jesus asked a powerful question: *"Now which of these three travelers do you think was a **neighbor** to the man who fell among robbers?"* The answer was so obvious that even the lawyer — who had tried to trick Jesus — could not deny it. Everyone in the crowd knew exactly who the real neighbor was.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus with East African/Eritrean features looking directly at the lawyer with a kind but penetrating gaze, one hand gesturing as He asks the question. The lawyer looks down, humbled, unable to meet Jesus's eyes. The crowd around them is silent and moved. Soft afternoon light. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm intimate teaching moment, focus on the eye contact between Jesus and the lawyer.*

Scene 20 of 25

The lawyer answered quietly, humbly: "*The one who showed him mercy.*" He couldn't even bring himself to say "the Samaritan" — but he knew the truth. The one who truly loved his neighbor was not the priest with all his religious knowledge, not the Levite with all his temple service, but the Samaritan who showed **real, practical love**. Jesus smiled and gave the lawyer — and all of us — a beautiful command: "**Go and do likewise.**"

□ **PICTURE:** *The lawyer with East African features standing humbly before Jesus, head slightly bowed as he gives his answer. Jesus smiles warmly, one hand raised in a gentle blessing gesture. The crowd looks on with understanding dawning on their faces. Golden warm light bathes the entire scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm hopeful colors, a moment of truth and transformation.*

Scene 21 of 25

"Go and do likewise!" What powerful words! Jesus was telling everyone that being a true neighbor has nothing to do with where you come from, what language you speak, or what group you belong to. A true neighbor is anyone who sees someone in need and **does something about it**. It's not enough to feel sorry for someone — we must ACT! We must be like the Samaritan: willing to stop, willing to give, willing to help — even when it costs us something, even when the person in need is different from us.

□ **PICTURE:** *A diverse group of children with East African/Eritrean features of different ages helping each other in various ways — one bandaging a knee, another sharing food, another helping someone up who fell. Set in a bright sunny community. Hearts and helping hands motif. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, joyful vibrant colors, modern application of the ancient story, warm community feeling.*

Scene 22 of 25

Dear children, **you** can be a Good Samaritan every single day! When you see a classmate sitting alone at lunch — be their neighbor and sit with them. When someone drops their books — help pick them up. When a friend is crying — comfort them. When someone is being bullied — stand up for them. You don't need silver coins or a donkey to help others. All you need is a **heart full of love** and the willingness to stop and care. Remember, Jesus said the greatest commandments are to love God and love others — and the Good Samaritan shows us exactly how!

□ **PICTURE:** *Children with East African/Eritrean features in a school setting performing various acts of kindness: sharing lunch, comforting a crying friend, helping with books, standing up against bullying. A warm golden glow surrounds each act of kindness. Jesus watches from above with a proud smile. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, bright cheerful school colors, warm and encouraging atmosphere.*

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | 📖📖📖📖

Let's think together: Have you ever walked past someone who needed help? Maybe you were busy, or scared, or didn't want to get involved — just like the priest and the Levite. That's okay — we all make mistakes. But now you know better! Next time you see someone in need, remember the Good Samaritan. Ask yourself: *"What would the Samaritan do?"* And then — with God's love in your heart — **go and do likewise!** Be brave, be kind, be the neighbor that Jesus calls you to be.

🖼️ **PICTURE:** *A child with East African/Eritrean features sitting thoughtfully under a tree, with a thought bubble showing the Good Samaritan helping the wounded man. The child has a determined, inspired expression, ready to act with kindness. Soft warm lighting, peaceful reflective atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, gentle contemplative colors with warm golden light filtering through leaves.*

Scene 24 of 25 — 📖📖📖 | In Tigrigna

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Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | ḲḲḲḲḲ

ḲḲ Moral Lesson | ḲḲḲḲḲ ḲḲḲḲ

True love has no boundaries — your neighbor is anyone who needs your help. The priest and Levite knew God's laws by heart, but they failed to show love in action. The Samaritan — an outsider and supposed enemy — showed what real love looks like: stopping, caring, giving, and sacrificing for someone in need. God doesn't ask us who **DESERVES** our help; He asks us to help **EVERYONE** we can!

Key Virtues: Compassion, Mercy, Generosity, Action, Unconditional Love, Kindness to Strangers

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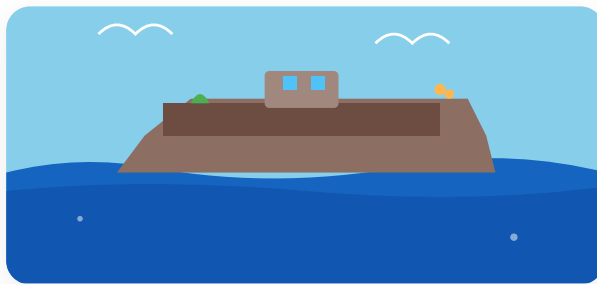
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4

□ Noah and the Great Ark

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□ Genesis 6-9 | □□□□□ 6-9



Scene 1 of 25

Long, long ago — many years after God created the beautiful world — something very sad happened. The people of the earth had become **terribly wicked**. They lied, they stole, they hurt one another, and they forgot all about God who made them. Every thought in their hearts was evil — all day, every day. They fought with each other, treated animals cruelly, and filled the world with violence and

darkness. God looked down from heaven at His beautiful creation and His heart was filled with **deep sorrow**.

□ **PICTURE:** *A panoramic view of an ancient world filled with chaos — people with East African/Eritrean features arguing, fighting, and being cruel to each other in a village setting. Dark storm clouds gather overhead symbolizing God's sadness. Contrast between the beautiful natural landscape and the ugly human behavior. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, darker muted tones showing the sadness of the scene while remaining appropriate for children.*

Scene 2 of 25

But in the middle of all this wickedness, there was **one good man**. His name was **Noah**. Noah loved God with all his heart. He was honest, kind, and fair. While everyone around him was doing terrible things, Noah chose to walk with God every single day. He taught his family — his wife, his three sons Shem, Ham, and Japheth, and their wives — to love God and do what was right. Noah was like a bright candle shining in a very dark room.

□ **PICTURE:** *Noah, an elderly man with East African/Eritrean features, grey beard, kind wise eyes, standing with his family — his wife beside him, three grown sons and their wives gathered around. They stand in prayer together, hands raised, a warm golden glow around them while the world behind them is darker. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm golden light on the family contrasting with the grey world behind, peaceful family portrait.*

Scene 3 of 25

One day, **God spoke to Noah**. His voice was serious and solemn: *"Noah, the end of all flesh has come before Me. The earth is filled with violence because of them. I am going to destroy them with the earth."* Noah trembled at God's words, but he listened carefully. God was going to send a great **flood** — water that would cover the entire earth — to wash away all the wickedness. But God had a plan to save Noah and his family because Noah had found **grace** in God's eyes.

□ **PICTURE:** Noah with East African/Eritrean features kneeling in prayer, eyes closed, face turned upward. A beam of heavenly golden light shines down on him from parting clouds above. His expression shows awe and reverence as he receives God's message. Simple outdoor setting with grass and a few trees. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dramatic divine light contrasting with the humble figure of Noah, sacred moment.

Scene 4 of 25

God gave Noah very specific instructions: *"Build an **ark** — a great boat — out of gopher wood. Make it 300 cubits long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high."* That's about 450 feet long — longer than a football field! It would have three floors, one window, and one door. God told Noah to coat it inside and outside with **pitch** to make it waterproof. Noah had never built a boat before — and this would be the biggest boat the world had ever seen! But Noah trusted God completely.

□ **PICTURE:** Noah with East African/Eritrean features looking at a vision or plan of the ark — a massive boat outline shown in golden light before him.

He holds building tools in his hands, looking determined. The scale is emphasized by tiny trees next to the ark's planned size. A scroll with measurements floats nearby. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm inspiring colors, showing the enormity of the task ahead with wonder rather than fear.

Scene 5 of 25

Noah began building immediately. Day after day, week after week, month after month, **year after year**, Noah and his sons worked on the ark. They cut down huge trees, shaped the wood with axes, and hammered planks together. The sound of sawing and hammering echoed across the land. It took them many, many years to build! People from nearby villages came to watch and they **laughed** at Noah. *"A giant boat? There's no ocean here! He must be crazy!"* they mocked. But Noah kept building, trusting God's word.

□ **PICTURE:** *Noah and his three sons with East African/Eritrean features working hard building the massive ark frame. They saw wood, hammer planks, and carry beams. The ark skeleton is partially built, enormous in scale. In the background, villagers point and laugh, holding their bellies in mockery. Wood shavings and tools scattered around. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm industrious colors, contrast between the faithful workers and the mocking crowd.*

Scene 6 of 25

While building, Noah also **preached** to the people. He warned them: *"Repent! Turn back to God! A flood is coming!"* But nobody listened. They thought Noah was foolish. They kept on with their wicked ways — eating, drinking, partying, and being cruel. *"Rain? What's rain?"* some laughed, for it had never rained before — the earth was watered by mist from the ground. Noah must have felt so alone sometimes, but he never gave up. He trusted God's promise and kept working faithfully.

□ **PICTURE:** Noah with East African/Eritrean features standing before a group of people, arms raised in warning, pleading with them to listen. His expression is earnest and caring. The people turn away dismissively, some laughing, some waving him off, some covering their ears. The partially-built ark is visible in the background. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm tones with an undercurrent of urgency, preaching scene.

Scene 7 of 25

Finally, after many long years of faithful work, the **ark was complete!** It stood tall and magnificent — a massive wooden ship sitting on dry land, towering above the trees. Three decks high, covered in waterproof pitch, strong enough to survive the mightiest storm. Noah and his family stood back and looked at what God had helped them build. It was enormous! Then God spoke again: *"In seven days, I will send rain upon the earth for forty days and forty nights."* The time had come.

□ **PICTURE:** The completed ark standing majestically on dry ground, towering above surrounding trees and Noah's family who stand small at its base

looking up in awe. The ark is massive, wooden, with a door on its side. East African/Eritrean featured family — Noah, wife, three sons and their wives — stand together gazing up. Late afternoon golden light. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, magnificent scale, warm proud achievement colors.

Scene 8 of 25

Then the most **amazing miracle** happened! God called the animals, and from every direction they came — walking, flying, crawling, hopping — heading straight for the ark! **Two by two** they came: two lions, two elephants, two giraffes, two rabbits, two eagles, two butterflies, two snakes, two monkeys — every kind of animal, bird, and creeping thing! They came peacefully, not fighting, guided by God's invisible hand. Noah didn't have to chase them or catch them — God brought them all to the ark!

□ **PICTURE:** *A magnificent procession of animals walking in pairs toward the ark — lions, elephants, giraffes, zebras, birds flying overhead, rabbits hopping, snakes slithering — all moving peacefully together in two orderly lines. Noah with East African/Eritrean features stands at the ark's ramp, welcoming them. Lush green landscape. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, joyful vibrant animal colors, magical peaceful procession, warm golden light.*

Scene 9 of 25

Noah and his family worked busily, guiding each pair of animals to their places on the three floors of the ark. They had prepared **food**

and water for every creature — hay for the horses, seeds for the birds, meat for the lions, fruit for the monkeys. The ark was like a floating zoo! Then Noah, his wife, his three sons — **Shem, Ham, and Japheth** — and their three wives entered the ark. Eight people in total. And then God Himself **shut the door** behind them. Click! It was sealed tight. No one else could get in.

□ **PICTURE:** *Interior of the ark showing Noah's family with East African/Eritrean features settling animals into stalls on multiple levels. Hay, grain sacks, and water troughs visible. Animals peek from stalls — a giraffe's head near the ceiling, sheep in pens, birds in wooden cages. Warm lamplight inside. Then the great door of the ark closing with divine golden light around its edges. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, cozy busy interior, warm amber lamplight.*

Scene 10 of 25

Seven days passed inside the ark. Then on the seventh day — **it began**. First, a rumble deep in the earth. Then the sky turned dark, darker than anyone had ever seen. Suddenly, the "*fountains of the great deep*" burst open — massive geysers of water shot up from underground! At the same time, the heavens opened and **rain** poured down like nothing ever before — not gentle drops, but sheets and walls of water crashing down from the sky! The people outside screamed in terror. Now they believed Noah — but it was too late.

□ **PICTURE:** *A dramatic stormy sky with torrential rain pouring down in sheets. The ground cracks open with water geysers shooting upward. The ark sits solid and safe while chaos erupts around it. Lightning flashes illuminate*

the dark sky. People outside in the distance run in panic. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dramatic dark blues and greys for the storm, the ark a warm brown safe haven amid the chaos, powerful natural forces.

Scene 11 of 25

The rain did not stop. It poured and poured for **forty days and forty nights** without ceasing! The water rose higher and higher. First it covered the roads, then the houses, then the trees. The ark began to **float**, lifted by the rising waters. Inside, Noah's family could hear the rain pounding on the roof and feel the ark rocking gently. The animals were safe and calm. God was protecting them all. Outside, the water kept rising until it covered even the tallest **mountains** — the whole earth was under water!

□ **PICTURE:** *The ark floating on vast endless waters under heavy rain. The water level is extremely high — only the very tops of mountains peek above the surface, soon to be covered. Heavy grey rain clouds fill the sky. The ark rides the waves, solid and safe. Inside through a small window, warm light glows showing safety within. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, vast blue-grey waterscape, the ark small but strong against the immense flood.*

Scene 12 of 25

Inside the ark, life went on. Noah and his family had much work to do every day — feeding all the animals, cleaning their stalls, giving them water, making sure the sick ones got well and the scared ones felt

safe. It was hard work, but they did it with grateful hearts, knowing that God had saved them. They could hear the **lions roar**, the **birds sing**, the **monkeys chatter**. Sometimes at night, they gathered together and prayed, thanking God for His protection and asking when the waters would go down.

□ **PICTURE:** *Interior of the ark showing Noah's family with East African/Eritrean features busy at work — one son carries hay to horses, another cleans a stall, Noah's wife feeds birds, Noah checks on a sick lamb. Animals are visible in their stalls. Warm oil lamp light illuminates the wooden interior. Everyone works together as a team. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm golden interior light, busy but peaceful domestic scene aboard the ark.*

Scene 13 of 25

After forty days, the rain finally stopped! But the water was still everywhere — a great ocean covering the whole world. They waited and waited. Days turned into weeks, weeks into months. Then one wonderful day, Noah felt the ark **bump and settle**! The ark had come to rest on the top of **Mount Ararat**! But they still couldn't go outside — water still covered everything below the mountain peak. Noah was patient. He knew God had a plan and a perfect timing for everything. They waited some more.

□ **PICTURE:** *The ark resting on a mountaintop (Mount Ararat) with water still visible all around below. The rain has stopped and clouds are breaking apart showing blue sky. Noah with East African/Eritrean features looks out of the ark window with hope, hand shading his eyes. Mountain peaks poke above the water in the distance. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style,*

transitional hopeful colors — dark waters but brightening sky, sense of waiting and patience.

Scene 14 of 25

Noah decided to send out a bird to check if the water had gone down. First, he released a **raven** — a strong black bird. The raven flew back and forth, back and forth, but found no dry land to rest on. Then Noah sent out a gentle **dove**. The dove flew out over the endless water, searching for dry ground, but found nothing. She came back to the ark, tired, and Noah gently caught her and brought her back inside. *"Not yet,"* Noah said patiently. *"We will try again."*

□ **PICTURE:** *Noah with East African/Eritrean features standing at the ark's window, releasing a white dove into a grey sky. The dove spreads its wings against a backdrop of receding floodwaters. A black raven circles in the distance. Noah's weathered hand gently opens to let the dove fly free. Water stretches in every direction below. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, soft grey-blue palette with the white dove as the focal point of hope.*

Scene 15 of 25

After waiting seven more days, Noah sent the dove out again. All day he waited, watching the sky anxiously. Then, as evening came, he saw her — the dove was flying back! And in her beak she carried something: a fresh, green **olive leaf**! Noah's heart leaped with joy! A green leaf meant that trees were growing again — the water was

going down! Land was appearing! Noah showed the leaf to his family and they all cheered and praised God. **Hope was alive!** The earth was coming back to life!

□ **PICTURE:** *A joyful scene — the dove returning to Noah at the ark window, carrying a bright green olive leaf in its beak. Noah with East African/Eritrean features reaches out with both hands, face beaming with joy and relief. His family gathers behind him, cheering. The olive leaf is vivid green against the blue-grey water background. Sunlight breaks through clouds. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, bright hopeful colors bursting through the grey, moment of pure joy.*

Scene 16 of 25

Noah waited seven more days and sent the dove out one final time. This time, she did **not come back!** She had found dry land with trees and food — a home! The water was gone! Then God spoke to Noah once more: *"Come out of the ark — you, your wife, your sons, and their wives. Bring out every animal so they may be fruitful and multiply on the earth."* Noah's heart soared! After more than a year on the ark, it was finally time to step out onto **dry ground** again!

□ **PICTURE:** *Noah with East African/Eritrean features standing at the now-open door of the ark, brilliant sunlight streaming in. His family stands behind him, squinting in the bright light after so long inside. Below the ramp, green grass and flowers are growing on the mountainside. Blue sky with fluffy white clouds. Fresh new world visible. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style,*

brilliant bright hopeful colors, dramatic transition from ark interior darkness to radiant outdoor light.

Scene 17 of 25

What a glorious moment! The great door of the ark swung open and **sunlight** poured in — warm, golden, beautiful sunlight! Noah stepped out first, his bare feet touching fresh green grass for the first time in over a year. He breathed in the clean, fresh air and tears of joy streamed down his face. Then his family came out, laughing and crying with happiness. The animals followed — bounding, galloping, flying, slithering out into the fresh new world! The lions roared, the birds sang, the horses galloped across the green meadows!

□ **PICTURE:** *Animals joyfully exiting the ark down a ramp — elephants trumpeting, birds bursting into flight, deer leaping, rabbits hopping into green grass. Noah's family with East African/Eritrean features stands to the side watching with tears of joy. Brilliant sunlight, blue sky, green landscape stretching out before them. A sense of new beginning and freedom. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, explosion of joyful vibrant colors, movement and celebration, the happiest moment.*

Scene 18 of 25

The first thing Noah did on the dry land was build an **altar** — a special pile of stones — and offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving to God. He knelt with his whole family, and they worshipped together,

thanking God for saving them through the terrible flood. *"Thank you, Lord, for protecting us. Thank you for keeping Your promise. Thank you for giving us a new beginning."* The sweet smell of Noah's offering rose up to heaven, and **God was pleased** with Noah's grateful heart.

□ **PICTURE:** Noah with East African/Eritrean features kneeling at a stone altar with his family around him, all in prayer with hands raised toward heaven. A gentle flame rises from the altar with smoke ascending straight up toward a bright sky. The ark visible in the background on the mountaintop. Fresh green landscape surrounds them. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, sacred worshipful atmosphere, warm golden light from above, peaceful gratitude.

Scene 19 of 25

Then God made a **beautiful promise** — a covenant that would last forever. He said to Noah: *"I will never again destroy the earth with a flood. Never again will water cover the whole world. As long as the earth remains, there will be seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and winter, day and night."* God promised that the seasons would continue, that life would go on, and that He would never send another worldwide flood. But God wanted to give Noah a special **sign** of this promise...

□ **PICTURE:** God's presence represented by warm golden light from above, speaking to Noah and his family who look up in awe and reverence. East African/Eritrean featured family standing together on green earth. Words of promise seem to shimmer in the air. The fresh new world stretches behind them with mountains, valleys, and blue sky. Watercolor children's Bible

illustration style, divine warm golden atmosphere, sense of sacred covenant being established.

Scene 20 of 25

God placed a magnificent **rainbow** in the sky! Every color of creation arched across the heavens — red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet — a stunning bridge of light from horizon to horizon! God said: *"This is the sign of My covenant. Whenever I bring clouds over the earth and a rainbow appears, I will remember My promise. Never again will floodwaters destroy all life."* Noah and his family gazed up in wonder at the most beautiful thing they had ever seen. Every rainbow since then reminds us of God's faithful promise!

□ **PICTURE:** *A spectacular, vivid rainbow arching across the entire sky over the fresh green landscape. Noah's family with East African/Eritrean features stands below gazing up in absolute wonder, arms raised in praise. Every color of the rainbow is vibrant and brilliant. The landscape below is lush and green. Clouds part to let sunlight through. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, the most colorful scene — every hue of the rainbow painted boldly and beautifully, pure wonder and joy.*

Scene 21 of 25

Noah and his family began their **new life** in the clean, fresh world. They planted gardens, grew food, and built homes. The animals spread across the earth — filling the forests, the seas, the skies, and

the plains. Life began again! Noah lived to be **950 years old** — and he never forgot God's faithfulness. He told his children and grandchildren the story of the ark, the flood, and the rainbow promise, so that no one would ever forget what God had done.

□ **PICTURE:** *A thriving new settlement — Noah's family with East African/Eritrean features working together building homes, planting gardens, tending animals. Children play in green meadows. Fruit trees grow. Animals graze peacefully in the background. A rainbow faintly visible in the sky as a constant reminder. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm prosperous community colors, sense of new beginning and abundant life.*

Scene 22 of 25

Dear children, the story of Noah teaches us so many important things! **First:** When everyone around you is doing wrong, you can still choose to do right — just like Noah did. **Second:** God always keeps His promises — even when we have to wait a long time. **Third:** Obedience to God protects us, even when His instructions seem strange to others. And **Fourth:** Every time you see a rainbow in the sky, remember — God loves you, God keeps His promises, and God always provides a way to save those who trust in Him!

□ **PICTURE:** *A modern child with East African/Eritrean features looking up at a rainbow in the sky after a rain shower, remembering Noah's story. A thought bubble shows the ark and animals. The child smiles with wonder and faith. Rain puddles reflect the rainbow colors. Suburban or village setting in*

background. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, bright hopeful colors, connecting ancient story to modern life, warm and inspiring.

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | ባብዓርዳ

Let's think together: Noah had to be patient for a very, very long time. He built the ark for many years while people laughed at him. He waited inside the ark for over a year while the flood waters rose and fell. But he never gave up! He kept trusting God even when things seemed impossible. Is there something in your life you're waiting for? Maybe you're waiting to grow up, or waiting for something hard to get better. Remember Noah — **God's timing is always perfect**, and He never forgets His promises to you!

▢ **PICTURE:** *A child with East African/Eritrean features sitting by a window on a rainy day, chin on hands, looking patient and thoughtful. Outside the window, rain falls but a rainbow is forming. On the wall behind the child is a picture of Noah's ark. The child's expression shows patient faith and hope. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, soft contemplative rainy-day colors with the rainbow as a bright promise breaking through.*

Scene 24 of 25 — ባብዓርዳ | In Tigrigna

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“你怎麼知道我的房間號碼？”他問。
“我猜的。”他回答。
“你怎麼知道我的房間號碼？”他問。
“我猜的。”他回答。

Obedience to God saves us, even when His instructions seem impossible or others laugh at us. Noah obeyed God for years while everyone mocked him — but in the end, his obedience saved his entire family! God always keeps His promises. When He says He will do something, He does it — whether it's sending the flood or painting the rainbow. Trust God, obey Him, and be patient — His timing is always perfect!

Key Virtues: Obedience, Faith, Patience, Perseverance, Gratitude,
Trust in God's Promises

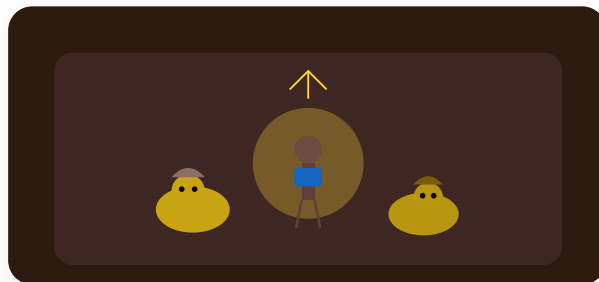
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5

□ Daniel in the Lions' Den

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□ Daniel 6 | □□□□ 6



Scene 1 of 25

In the mighty kingdom of **Babylon**, there lived a man named **Daniel**. Daniel was not from Babylon — he had been taken from his homeland of Israel as a young boy, many years ago. But even in a foreign land, Daniel never forgot God. He prayed every single day, three times a day, without fail. He was honest, hardworking, and wise. God blessed Daniel with amazing wisdom, and he rose to

become one of the most important leaders in the entire kingdom — serving under King **Darius** the Mede.

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel, an elderly but strong man with East African/Eritrean features, standing in a grand Babylonian palace with columns and golden decorations. He wears fine official robes but has a humble, prayerful posture. Behind him, the grand palace architecture with hanging gardens and ornate carvings. Warm golden lamplight illuminates the scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, rich palace colors of gold, blue, and purple.*

Scene 2 of 25

King Darius trusted Daniel so much that he planned to make him ruler over the **entire kingdom** — above all the other officials! Daniel was the best administrator in the land: he never lied, never stole, never made mistakes with the king's business. He was **faithful, honest, and completely trustworthy**. The king could see that Daniel had an excellent spirit — something special that made him different from everyone else. That special something was Daniel's deep, unwavering faith in the **one true God**.

□ **PICTURE:** *King Darius on his throne, impressed, gesturing toward Daniel who stands before him with a humble bow. Other officials stand in the background, watching with jealous expressions. The throne room is ornate with golden columns and rich tapestries. Daniel wears official robes with East African/Eritrean features, dignified and humble. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, royal purples and golds, contrast between Daniel's humility and the grandeur of the court.*

Scene 3 of 25

But the other officials were **burning with jealousy**! They hated that Daniel — a foreigner! — was more successful than they were. They whispered in dark corners, plotting against him. *"We must find something wrong with Daniel,"* they schemed. *"We must find a mistake, a scandal, a reason to destroy him!"* So they watched Daniel carefully. They followed him. They checked his records. They examined every decision he made. But no matter how hard they searched, they could find **absolutely nothing wrong**. Daniel was completely blameless!

□ **PICTURE:** *A group of jealous officials with East African/Eritrean features huddled together in a dark palace corridor, whispering and plotting. Their faces show envy and scheming. They point toward a distant doorway where Daniel can be seen working honestly at a desk. Shadowy atmosphere for the plotters, contrasting with the honest light around Daniel. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dark conspiratorial colors for the plotters, warm honest light for Daniel.*

Scene 4 of 25

The jealous officials realized something: *"We will never find any fault in Daniel regarding the kingdom's business. The only way we can trap him is through the **laws of his God!**"* They knew Daniel prayed to his God three times every day — it was as regular as the sunrise. They hatched a wicked plan: they would convince the king to make a law that would make Daniel's prayers **illegal**! It was a cruel, sneaky trap

designed to destroy the one man in the kingdom who truly honored God.

❑ **PICTURE:** *The group of scheming officials with East African/Eritrean features gathered around a table with a scroll, one of them writing with a quill, evil smiles on their faces. A window shows Daniel in the distance praying at his window — the target of their plot. Dark interior contrasts with the peaceful image of Daniel praying. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, sinister dark tones for the plotters with their scroll, warm light on distant Daniel at prayer.*

Scene 5 of 25

The officials rushed to King Darius, bowing low with fake smiles. *"O King Darius, live forever!"* they said sweetly. *"All the officials, governors, and advisors have agreed that you should issue a royal decree: for the next **thirty days**, no one may pray to any god or man except to you, O King! Anyone who disobeys shall be thrown into the **den of lions**!"* King Darius was flattered — he didn't realize it was a trap aimed at Daniel. Feeling proud, he signed the decree and sealed it with his royal ring. According to the law of the Medes and Persians, it **could not be changed**.

❑ **PICTURE:** *The scheming officials with East African/Eritrean features presenting an ornate scroll to King Darius on his throne. The king looks pleased and flattered, reaching for his signet ring to seal it. The officials smile cunningly. A royal seal and wax are on a table nearby. Grand throne room setting with rich curtains. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style,*

deceptive warmth of flattery, rich royal colors, the ominous sealed scroll as the focal point.

Scene 6 of 25

When Daniel heard about the new law, he knew exactly what it meant — it was aimed at **him**. He knew that if he prayed to God, he would be thrown to the lions. He knew the punishment was death. But did Daniel stop praying? **No!** Did he hide? **No!** Did he pray secretly in a closet where no one could see? **No!** Daniel went home, climbed to his upper room, opened his windows wide toward Jerusalem — just as he had always done — knelt down, and **prayed to God**, thanking Him and asking for help, just as he did three times every single day.

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel with East African/Eritrean features kneeling in prayer at his open window, hands clasped, face peaceful and determined. The window faces toward Jerusalem (indicated by a distant city skyline). Warm golden sunlight streams through the open window onto Daniel. His room is simple but dignified. His expression shows faith without fear. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm golden prayer light, peaceful defiance, the open window as a bold statement of faith.*

Scene 7 of 25

The jealous officials were watching! They had been waiting outside Daniel's house, peeking through the bushes, hoping to catch him in the act. And there he was — praying openly at his window, just as

they expected! They rubbed their hands together with wicked glee. *"Got him!"* they whispered to each other. They rushed back to the palace, tripping over each other in their excitement to report Daniel to the king. Their evil trap had worked — or so they thought. They did not know that **God** was watching too.

□ **PICTURE:** *The jealous officials with East African/Eritrean features hiding in bushes outside Daniel's house, peering up at his window where he is visible praying. Their faces show malicious excitement as they catch him. One points up at the window, another runs toward the palace. Shadows and bushes frame their sneaking figures. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, contrast between the sneaky dark figures below and the peaceful golden-lit prayer scene above.*

Scene 8 of 25

The officials burst into the throne room: *"O King! Did you not sign a decree that for thirty days, anyone who prays to any god except you shall be thrown into the lions' den?"* The king nodded, *"Yes, the law stands and cannot be changed."* Then they delivered their cruel news: *"Daniel, who is one of the captives from Judah, does not respect you or your decree, O King! He still prays to his God **three times a day!**"* The king's face fell. His heart sank. He suddenly realized — **it was a trap!** And his beloved Daniel was caught in it!

□ **PICTURE:** *The throne room — officials with East African/Eritrean features standing triumphantly before King Darius, who sits on his throne with a horrified, anguished expression, realizing the trap. One official points accusingly while others smirk. The king grips the arms of his throne, his face showing grief and regret. Dramatic lighting emphasizes the king's distress.*

Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, emotional royal blues and golds, the king's anguish as the central focus.

Scene 9 of 25

King Darius was **deeply distressed**. He loved Daniel! He didn't want to punish him! All day long — from morning until the sun went down — the king tried desperately to find a way to save Daniel. He consulted his wisest advisors, searched through every law book, tried every legal argument. But the officials kept coming back: *"Remember, O King — the law of the Medes and Persians cannot be changed! Not even by you!"* The king was trapped by his own law. There was nothing he could do. His heart broke for his faithful friend Daniel.

□ **PICTURE:** *King Darius with East African/Eritrean features pacing his private chamber in distress, scrolls and law books spread on tables around him. His crown sits crooked, his robes disheveled. Through a window, the sun is setting — time is running out. His face shows deep worry and grief. Servants watch with concern from doorways. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, anxious warm sunset colors, the weight of helplessness on the king's shoulders, scattered papers showing desperate searching.*

Scene 10 of 25

As the sun set, the king had no choice. With tears in his eyes, he gave the terrible order. Soldiers came and took Daniel gently — for even they respected him. As Daniel was led away, King Darius rushed to

him and said with a breaking voice: *"Daniel, may your God, whom you serve continually, deliver you!"* Daniel looked at the king with peace in his eyes — not anger, not fear, but **perfect peace**. He trusted God completely. Whatever happened in the lions' den, Daniel knew his God was with him.

□ **PICTURE:** *A deeply emotional scene — King Darius with East African/Eritrean features grasping Daniel's hands, tears on his face, speaking his blessing. Daniel stands calm and peaceful between two respectful soldiers. The evening sky glows orange and purple behind them. Daniel's serene face contrasts with the king's anguish. Palace courtyard setting. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, emotional sunset colors, the tender farewell between king and faithful servant, bittersweet warmth.*

Scene 11 of 25

Daniel was brought to the **lions' den** — a deep pit carved into rock, where the king kept fierce, hungry lions. The soldiers lifted the heavy stone cover. From below came the terrifying sounds of **growling and roaring**. The lions hadn't been fed — they were hungry and savage. Daniel looked down into the dark pit. He could see their glowing eyes and sharp teeth. But Daniel did not scream. He did not beg. He simply **prayed silently** to his God, and then he was lowered down into the darkness among the beasts.

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel with East African/Eritrean features being lowered by ropes into a dark stone pit. His face is calm and prayerful, eyes closed, hands folded. Above, soldiers and the grieving king watch. Below in the shadows, the glowing eyes of lions are visible. Torchlight from above illuminates Daniel's peaceful face against the dark pit. Watercolor children's Bible illustration*

style, dramatic contrast of light above and darkness below, Daniel's faith as a light in the darkness.

Scene 12 of 25

A great stone was placed over the mouth of the den, and King Darius sealed it with his own ring and the rings of his nobles — so no one could rescue Daniel by human means. The king whispered one more time: *"May your God save you, Daniel."* Then he turned and walked back to the palace, his head bowed, his heart heavy with grief. The jealous officials smiled in the shadows, thinking they had won. But they did not know what God was about to do in that dark den of lions!

□ **PICTURE:** *A large round stone being rolled over the top of the lions' den by soldiers. King Darius with East African/Eritrean features presses his signet ring into a wax seal on the stone, tears on his face. Torchlight illuminates the somber scene against the dark night sky. The jealous officials lurk in the background with satisfied smirks. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dark solemn atmosphere, the sealed stone as a symbol of seeming finality, flickering torchlight.*

Scene 13 of 25

Down in the dark den, something **miraculous** was happening! As Daniel landed among the lions, God sent His **angel** — a powerful, shining heavenly being — into the pit! The angel's presence filled the

den with a gentle, warm glow. And the angel did something amazing: he **shut the lions' mouths**! Those fierce, hungry beasts suddenly became as gentle as kittens. They closed their mighty jaws, lay down peacefully, and did not touch Daniel at all. Not a scratch, not a bite, not even a growl. God's angel stood guard all night long.

□ **PICTURE:** *Inside the dark lions' den — a glowing angel with magnificent wings fills the space with warm golden light. Daniel with East African/Eritrean features sits peacefully among several large lions who lie calmly around him like house cats. The angel's hands are extended over the lions' heads. Daniel's face shows peaceful gratitude. The lions' mouths are gently closed, their eyes calm. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, miraculous golden angelic light in the dark den, peaceful impossible scene, warm divine protection.*

Scene 14 of 25

Daniel spent the entire night in the lions' den, but it was not a night of terror — it was a night of **peace and worship**! With God's angel watching over him and the lions lying peacefully at his feet, Daniel prayed and praised God all through the dark hours. He even **leaned against one of the big lions** as if it were a warm, furry pillow! The lion purred softly. Daniel smiled in the darkness. He had trusted God, and God had shown up in the most powerful way possible. His faith was being rewarded!

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel with East African/Eritrean features resting peacefully against a large, gentle lion in the den, one hand on the lion's mane. Other lions sleep peacefully around him. A soft golden glow from the angel (now faded to a gentle presence) illuminates the scene. Daniel looks content and worshipful, eyes turned upward in thanks. Warm amber tones in the*

darkness. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, cozy impossible peace, warm intimate night scene, faith rewarded.

Scene 15 of 25

Meanwhile, back at the palace, King Darius was having the **worst night of his life**. He could not eat — he pushed away every plate of food his servants brought. He could not sleep — he tossed and turned on his royal bed. He refused all entertainment — no music, no dancing, no distractions. All night long he paced his chambers, worrying about Daniel. *"Is he alive? Did the lions spare him? Oh, why did I sign that foolish decree!"* As soon as the first light of dawn appeared in the sky, the king leaped from his bed and ran.

□ **PICTURE:** *King Darius with East African/Eritrean features in his royal bedchamber, sitting on the edge of his ornate bed unable to sleep. Untouched food platters sit on a nearby table. His face is drawn with worry, hands clasped. A window shows the night sky. Servants hover in doorways looking concerned. Candles flicker low. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dark sleepless night atmosphere, royal blues and purples, the king's lonely worried vigil, emotional isolation.*

Scene 16 of 25

At the very first light of dawn, King Darius **ran** to the lions' den! He didn't walk — he ran! His royal robes flying behind him, his sandals slapping the stone floors, his crown nearly falling off. He raced

through the palace corridors, down the steps, across the courtyard, straight to the sealed den. His servants could barely keep up! When he reached the stone, he fell to his knees and cried out with a trembling, anguished voice: *"Daniel! Daniel! Servant of the living God! Has your God been able to save you from the lions?"*

□ **PICTURE:** King Darius with East African/Eritrean features running at dawn toward the lions' den, robes and crown disheveled, face desperate with hope and fear. Early morning pink and gold light fills the sky. He kneels at the sealed stone, calling down into the darkness. Servants trail behind him. The sealed stone is large and imposing. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dramatic dawn colors of pink, gold, and purple, the king's desperate urgency, running motion captured in flowing robes.

Scene 17 of 25

Then — from deep within the dark pit — came the most wonderful sound the king had ever heard: **Daniel's voice!** Clear, strong, and cheerful! *"O King, live forever! My God sent His angel and shut the lions' mouths! They have not hurt me, because I was found innocent before God. And also before you, O King, I have done no wrong!"* King Darius could hardly believe his ears! He jumped to his feet, laughing and crying at the same time! *"He's alive! He's ALIVE! Daniel is alive!"* he shouted with pure joy!

□ **PICTURE:** The moment of joy — King Darius with East African/Eritrean features leaping up from the stone with arms raised in celebration, tears of joy on his face, mouth open in a shout of happiness. Below in the den, Daniel's face is visible looking up with a smile, perfectly unharmed, lions peaceful around him. Golden morning light floods the scene. Watercolor

children's Bible illustration style, explosive joy colors — gold, warm yellow, bright orange — the most celebratory moment, pure relief and happiness.

Scene 18 of 25

The king immediately commanded his servants to **lift Daniel out** of the den! They rolled away the heavy stone, lowered ropes, and pulled Daniel up into the morning sunlight. And when they examined him — not a single scratch, not a single wound, not even a **bruise** was found on his body! His clothes weren't even torn! It was as if he had spent the night in the safest room in the palace, not in a pit full of hungry lions! The king embraced Daniel tightly, overwhelmed with relief and amazement at the power of Daniel's God.

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel with East African/Eritrean features being lifted out of the den into brilliant morning sunlight, arms raised in triumph and praise. King Darius embraces him. Daniel is completely unharmed — no scratches, clean robes, peaceful face. Soldiers and servants stare in amazement. Golden morning light creates a halo effect around Daniel. The open den below shows peaceful lions. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, triumphant golden resurrection-like imagery, pure celebration and amazement.*

Scene 19 of 25

Then the king turned his attention to those **wicked officials** who had tricked him and plotted against Daniel. His joy turned to righteous anger. He commanded that those men — along with their families —

be thrown into the very same lions' den they had prepared for Daniel. And this time, God did NOT shut the lions' mouths. The lions showed the accusers no mercy. Justice was served. The very trap they had set for the innocent man **caught them instead**. This is what happens when people plot evil against God's faithful servants.

□ **PICTURE:** King Darius with East African/Eritrean features pointing sternly as soldiers lead the terrified plotting officials away. The officials' faces show fear and regret — their evil plan has backfired on them. Daniel stands calmly beside the king. The lions' den entrance is visible in the background. Justice is being served. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, dramatic contrast between the calm justice of the king and the terror of the guilty plotters, strong decisive colors.

Scene 20 of 25

King Darius was so amazed by Daniel's God that he wrote a **decree** to every nation, people, and language in his vast kingdom: *"I command that everyone shall tremble and fear before the God of Daniel! For He is the **living God**, and He endures forever. His kingdom shall never be destroyed. He delivers and rescues, He works signs and wonders in heaven and on earth. He has delivered Daniel from the power of the **lions!**"* Because of Daniel's faithfulness, the whole world learned about the one true God!

□ **PICTURE:** King Darius with East African/Eritrean features standing on a palace balcony, reading his new decree to a vast crowd below. He holds up a scroll. Daniel stands beside him honored. The crowd stretches far into the city streets. Banners and flags wave. The sun shines brightly. People of many nations listen in awe. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, grand

panoramic proclamation scene, rich royal colors, God being glorified before the nations, triumphant atmosphere.

Scene 21 of 25

Daniel **prospered** in the kingdom — he continued to serve faithfully and was honored and blessed for the rest of his long life. His story teaches us that when we are faithful to God, He is always faithful to us! Daniel could have easily hidden his prayers. He could have closed his windows. He could have said, "I'll pray secretly for just thirty days." But Daniel chose to honor God **openly and boldly**, no matter the cost. And God honored Daniel's courage by shutting the mouths of lions!

□ **PICTURE:** *Daniel with East African/Eritrean features in his later years, still praying at his open window toward Jerusalem, the same faithful practice he never abandoned. Golden sunset light streams through the window. He looks peaceful, content, and blessed. The city of Babylon is visible through the window, thriving. His room is comfortable with scrolls and signs of wisdom. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm golden peaceful contentment, faithful consistency through the years, life well-lived.*

Scene 22 of 25

Dear children, what "lions" do you face in your life? Maybe it's friends who want you to do wrong things. Maybe it's fear of being different. Maybe it's people who make fun of you for praying or going to

church. Remember Daniel! He showed us that **faithfulness to God is always worth it** — even when it's dangerous, even when it's hard, even when everyone else takes the easy way out. God shut the mouths of real lions for Daniel, and He can shut the mouths of any "lions" in your life too! Just keep praying, keep trusting, and keep being faithful!

□ **PICTURE:** *A modern child with East African/Eritrean features kneeling in prayer beside their bed, brave and peaceful expression. Around them, "lions" are shown as shadows representing fears, peer pressure, and challenges — but they are held back by an invisible force (God's protection). A warm golden protective glow surrounds the praying child. Bedroom setting with a Bible on the nightstand. Watercolor children's Bible illustration style, warm safe bedroom colors, the child as a modern Daniel, faith conquering fears.*

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | □□□□□□

Let's think together: Daniel prayed three times every day — morning, noon, and night. He didn't just pray when he was in trouble; he prayed ALL the time! That's why his faith was so strong when the test came. It's like exercise — if you only try to run on race day, you won't be ready. But if you practice every day, you'll be strong when it matters most! Start building your own prayer habit today. Talk to God in the morning when you wake up, at meals, and before bed. When the "lions" come — and they will — your faith will be **unshakable**!

□ **PICTURE:** *A split scene showing a child with East African/Eritrean features praying at three different times: morning (sunrise in window), midday (bright sun), and evening (moon visible). Each scene shows the same child growing*

Scene 24 of 25 — □□□□□ | In Tigrigna

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Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | በሰላም

■ Moral Lesson | በሰላም ሰላም

Stay faithful to God no matter what — even when it's dangerous, even when everyone is against you. Daniel refused to compromise his faith, even when it meant facing hungry lions! He prayed openly and boldly, trusting that God was bigger than any threat. And God proved Himself faithful — shutting the lions' mouths and delivering Daniel completely unharmed. When you stand firm in faith, God stands with you!

Key Virtues: Faithfulness, Courage, Prayer, Consistency, Trust in God, Boldness, Integrity

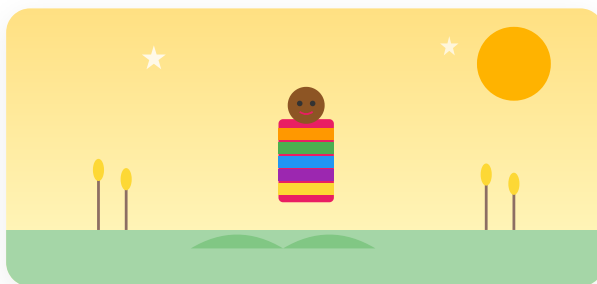
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6

Joseph and His Colorful Coat

□□□□ □□□□ □□□□

□ Genesis 37–50 | □□□□□ 37–50

**Scene 1 of 25**

In the land of **Canaan**, there lived a man named **Jacob** who had twelve sons. But of all his sons, Jacob loved **Joseph** the most. Joseph was seventeen years old — a kind, honest, and faithful boy who loved God with all his heart. His father's face would light up whenever Joseph was near.

□ **PICTURE:** *An elderly father (Jacob) with his arm around a handsome 17-year-old boy (Joseph). They stand in green Canaan pastureland with sheep grazing. East African/Eritrean features, warm brown skin. Jacob wearing traditional robes. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 2 of 25

One special day, Jacob called Joseph to him. *"My son, I have a gift for you,"* he said with sparkling eyes. He presented Joseph with the most **beautiful coat** anyone had ever seen! It was made of many colors — red, blue, purple, gold, and green — like a rainbow you could wear. Joseph's eyes went wide with joy!

□ **PICTURE:** *Jacob presenting a magnificent multi-colored coat to young Joseph. The coat has vivid stripes of red, blue, purple, gold, and green. Joseph's face full of wonder and joy. East African/Eritrean features. Inside a tent with warm light. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 3 of 25

But Joseph's older brothers watched with anger burning in their hearts. *"Why does Father love him more than us?"* they whispered. *"Look at that fancy coat — he thinks he's better than us!"* Jealousy grew like a dark weed in their hearts. They couldn't even speak a kind word to Joseph anymore.

□ **PICTURE:** Group of angry older brothers (10 men) huddled together whispering, dark expressions on their faces. In the distance, Joseph wearing his colorful coat tending sheep happily. East African/Eritrean features. Harsh shadows on brothers' faces contrasting with bright light on Joseph. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 4 of 25

Then Joseph had a **dream from God**! He excitedly told his brothers: *"Listen! I dreamed we were binding sheaves of wheat in the field. My sheaf stood up straight, and all your sheaves bowed down to mine!"* His brothers' faces turned red with fury. *"Do you think you will rule over us?!"* they shouted.

□ **PICTURE:** Dream sequence: golden wheat sheaves in a field, one tall sheaf standing upright in center while eleven sheaves bow down around it. Glowing dreamlike atmosphere with soft gold light. Stars scattered in background. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with magical dream quality.

Scene 5 of 25

Joseph had another dream — even more amazing! *"I saw the sun, the moon, and eleven stars all bowing down to me!"* Even his father Jacob was surprised. *"What is this dream? Shall your mother and I and your brothers bow to you?"* But Jacob kept these words in his heart, wondering what God had planned for his special son.

□ **PICTURE:** *Dream vision: a bright sun, crescent moon, and eleven glowing stars all bowing down toward a single bright figure. Deep blue night sky with cosmic wonder. Magical, divine atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with celestial beauty.*

Scene 6 of 25

One day, Jacob sent Joseph to check on his brothers who were grazing the flocks far away in **Shechem**. Joseph walked alone through the hills and valleys, wearing his beautiful coat. When his brothers saw him coming from a distance — that colorful coat was easy to spot — hatred filled their hearts. *"Here comes the dreamer!"* they said with venom.

□ **PICTURE:** *Joseph walking alone through rolling green hills, his colorful coat bright against the landscape. In the distance, his brothers huddle together plotting. Sheep scattered around. East African/Eritrean features. Ominous clouds gathering. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 7 of 25

The brothers grabbed Joseph roughly! They ripped his beautiful colorful coat right off his back. Joseph cried out, *"Brothers! What are you doing?! Please stop!"* But they showed no mercy. They threw him into a deep, dark, empty pit. Joseph looked up from the bottom, tears streaming down his face, as his brothers laughed cruelly above.

□ **PICTURE:** *Joseph being grabbed by his brothers, his colorful coat being torn away. Joseph's face showing shock and fear. One brother holding the coat triumphantly. A dark pit/cistern visible. East African/Eritrean features. Dramatic, emotional scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 8 of 25

Then a caravan of **Ishmaelite traders** appeared on the horizon — camels loaded with spices heading to Egypt. Judah, one of the brothers, had a terrible idea: "*Let's sell Joseph as a slave! We'll get money AND be rid of him!*" For just **twenty pieces of silver**, they sold their own brother to strangers. Joseph begged and pleaded, but they turned away.

□ **PICTURE:** *A caravan of traders with camels loaded with goods. Joseph being handed over to traders, his hands bound with rope. Brothers receiving silver coins. Joseph looking back with tears. Desert landscape. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

The traders took Joseph far away to **Egypt** — a strange foreign land where he knew no one. He was sold as a **slave** to a rich Egyptian official named **Potiphar**, captain of Pharaoh's guard. Young Joseph was alone, scared, and far from home. But even in the darkest place, God was with Joseph. He never left him.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph standing in an Egyptian marketplace being sold, looking small and alone among tall Egyptian buildings and pyramids. Potiphar pointing at Joseph. Chains on Joseph's wrists. Strange new land. But a subtle golden glow around Joseph showing God's presence. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 10 of 25

In Potiphar's house, Joseph worked hard and honestly. **Everything Joseph touched was blessed by God!** The crops grew better, the animals multiplied, the household prospered. Potiphar noticed and made Joseph head of his entire household. *"God is truly with this young man,"* Potiphar said with amazement.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph managing a grand Egyptian household. He's organizing servants, overseeing gardens that bloom abundantly. Potiphar watching approvingly from a balcony. Egyptian architecture with columns and palm trees. Joseph looks confident and capable. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 11 of 25

But then terrible trouble came! Potiphar's wife told **wicked lies** about Joseph. She falsely accused him of doing wrong. Joseph was innocent — he had done nothing wrong! But Potiphar believed his wife. In a rage, he threw Joseph into the **royal prison**. Once again, Joseph was in a dark place. But once again, God was right there with him.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph being led to prison in chains by Egyptian guards. He looks upward with faith despite his suffering. Dark prison door opening. Potiphar's wife pointing accusingly in background. Contrast between dark prison and divine light on Joseph's face. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 12 of 25

Even in prison, Joseph shone like a light! He helped other prisoners, worked hard, and stayed faithful to God. The prison keeper put Joseph in charge of all the other prisoners. Then one night, two special prisoners — Pharaoh's **baker** and **cupbearer** — each had strange dreams that troubled them greatly.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph in prison, but looking peaceful and kind. He sits between two worried-looking men (baker and cupbearer) who are telling him about their dreams. Prison cell with barred window showing moonlight. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 13 of 25

Joseph said, "**God can reveal the meaning of dreams!**" He interpreted their dreams perfectly: the cupbearer would be freed in three days, but the baker would not survive. Everything happened exactly as Joseph said! God gave Joseph a special gift of understanding dreams. But the cupbearer forgot about Joseph for **two whole years**.

□ **PICTURE:** *Joseph speaking confidently, one hand raised, interpreting dreams. The cupbearer looking hopeful, the baker looking worried. A vision of a grapevine with three branches above the cupbearer. Light emanating from Joseph. Prison setting. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 14 of 25

Two years later, **Pharaoh himself** — the most powerful man in the world — had a terrifying dream! He saw seven fat cows eaten by seven skinny cows, and seven plump wheat heads swallowed by seven thin ones. No one in all of Egypt could explain it. Then the cupbearer finally remembered: *"I know a man in prison who interprets dreams!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *Pharaoh on his throne looking disturbed and sleepless. Dream vision above him showing seven fat cows and seven thin cows. Egyptian advisors shaking their heads. The cupbearer stepping forward with raised hand. Grand Egyptian palace. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 15 of 25

Joseph was rushed from prison, cleaned up, and brought before Pharaoh! With confidence from God, Joseph spoke: *"God is showing you what will happen. Seven years of great plenty will come, then seven years of terrible famine. Store grain during the good years to survive the bad ones!"* Pharaoh was amazed at Joseph's wisdom.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph standing before Pharaoh in the grand Egyptian palace, speaking boldly. Pharaoh leaning forward on his throne, fascinated. Courtiers and advisors amazed. Joseph clean and dignified despite coming from prison. Golden Egyptian columns and decorations. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 16 of 25

Pharaoh was so impressed that he made Joseph the **second most powerful person in all of Egypt!** He put a gold ring on Joseph's finger, dressed him in fine linen, and placed a gold chain around his neck. *"Only I on the throne will be greater than you!"* Pharaoh declared. From slave and prisoner to ruler — God's plan was unfolding!

□ **PICTURE:** Pharaoh placing a gold chain around Joseph's neck. Joseph wearing fine white Egyptian linen with gold jewelry. Royal signet ring being placed on his finger. Egyptian court watching in awe. Chariot behind Joseph. East African/Eritrean features. Glorious, triumphant scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 17 of 25

For seven years, Joseph wisely stored mountains of grain in great storehouses all across Egypt. Then the famine came — terrible and devastating. Every nation suffered. People everywhere were hungry and desperate. But Egypt had food! People from all lands came to Egypt to buy grain. And who was in charge of all the food? **Joseph!**

□ **PICTURE:** *Massive Egyptian storehouses overflowing with golden grain. Joseph directing workers filling granaries. Then contrasting scene of dry, cracked earth with withered crops. People from many nations lining up at Egypt's gates. East African/Eritrean features on Joseph. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

Back in Canaan, Jacob's family was starving too. Jacob sent his sons to Egypt to buy grain. The ten brothers traveled far and came before the governor — not knowing it was their own brother Joseph! They **bowed down** before him with their faces to the ground. Joseph recognized them immediately, but they did not recognize him.

□ **PICTURE:** *Ten brothers bowing face-down before Joseph who sits on a high Egyptian throne. Joseph wearing Egyptian royal clothing, looking down at his brothers with emotion hidden behind a stern face. Grand throne room. The dream of sheaves bowing fulfilled. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

Joseph tested his brothers to see if they had changed. He spoke harshly: "**You are spies!**" He kept one brother as prisoner and sent the rest home with grain but demanded they bring the youngest brother, **Benjamin**, next time. He hid money back in their sacks! Joseph wanted to see if they would protect Benjamin or betray him too.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph on throne pointing accusingly at his brothers, disguised as stern Egyptian ruler. Brothers on their knees pleading innocence. Guards standing nearby. One brother (Simeon) being taken away. Grain sacks in foreground. East African/Eritrean features. Tense atmosphere. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 20 of 25

When the brothers returned with Benjamin, Joseph could hardly contain his emotions. Seeing his little brother, he rushed to another room and **wept**. He missed his family so much! After more testing, he saw that his brothers truly had changed — Judah even offered himself as a slave to protect Benjamin. Their hearts were no longer cruel.

□ **PICTURE:** Joseph in a private room, weeping with overwhelming emotion, hand over his mouth. Through a doorway, his brothers and young Benjamin visible in the banquet hall. Tears of joy and longing. Egyptian room with beautiful furnishings. East African/Eritrean features. Deeply emotional. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 21 of 25

Joseph could hold back no longer! He sent all the Egyptian servants away and cried out with a loud voice: **"I am Joseph! I am your brother — the one you sold into Egypt!"** His brothers were terrified and

speechless! Their faces went white with shock. Was this really Joseph? The boy they had thrown into a pit?!

□ **PICTURE:** *The great reveal: Joseph standing with arms open, tears streaming, declaring his identity. His brothers stumbling backward in absolute shock, mouths open, some falling to their knees. Dramatic lighting. Egyptian throne room. East African/Eritrean features. Most emotional scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

But instead of anger or revenge, Joseph spoke words of **forgiveness**: *"Don't be afraid! Don't be angry with yourselves for selling me. God sent me ahead of you to save lives! You meant it for evil, but **God meant it for good!**"* He hugged each brother, weeping on their necks. He brought his whole family — including his elderly father Jacob — to live safely in Egypt!

□ **PICTURE:** *Joseph embracing his brothers in a group hug, everyone weeping with joy and relief. Then Jacob (elderly, with staff) reuniting with Joseph — father and son embracing after 20+ years apart. Family together again. East African/Eritrean features. Joyful, healing scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | □□□□□□

Joseph's story teaches us that **God can turn the worst situations into the greatest blessings**. Sold as a slave at seventeen, falsely accused, forgotten in prison — yet God never abandoned Joseph. Every trial was a stepping stone. Every setback was setup for a comeback! When we trust God and keep doing right, even our enemies' plans become part of God's greater purpose. Joseph waited over 13 years, but God's timing was perfect!

□ **PICTURE:** A timeline montage showing Joseph's journey: the pit, the slave market, Potiphar's house, prison, before Pharaoh, and finally ruling Egypt with family reunited. Each phase connected by a golden thread showing God's plan. Rainbow-colored coat visible in first and last images. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 24 of 25 — □□□□□ | In Tigrigna

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 "I will not be a slave," Joseph said. "I will only be a servant of my master."

Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | Joseph

□ Moral Lesson | Joseph's Story

God can turn every bad thing into something good when you trust Him. Joseph was sold, enslaved, lied about, and imprisoned — but he never gave up on God, and God never gave up on him! Thirteen years of pain became a lifetime of purpose. Joseph chose forgiveness over bitterness, and God elevated him from a pit to a palace! No matter what you go through, keep trusting God's plan.

Key Virtues: Forgiveness, Patience, Trust in God, Faithfulness, Perseverance, Grace, Family Love

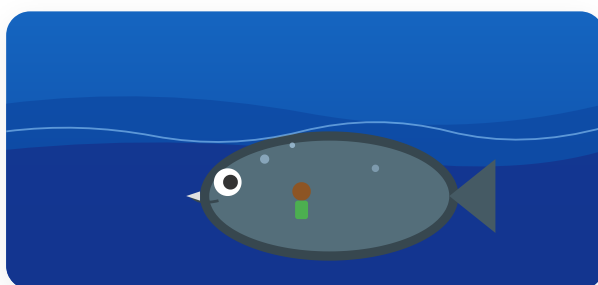
"But I will not be a slave," Joseph said. "I will only be a servant of my master."
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 "I will not be a slave," Joseph said. "I will only be a servant of my master."

7

Jonah and the Big Fish

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□ Jonah 1-4 | □□□ 1-4



Scene 1 of 25

In the ancient land of Israel, there lived a prophet named **Jonah**. He loved God and spoke God's messages to the people. One day, the voice of the Lord came to Jonah — clear, powerful, and unmistakable: *"Jonah! Get up and go to the great city of **Nineveh**. Preach against their wickedness, for their evil has come before Me."*

□ **PICTURE:** Prophet Jonah standing in an Israelite village, looking upward as divine golden light shines down on him from heaven. He's a middle-aged man wearing simple robes. East African/Eritrean features. Blue sky with dramatic God-rays. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 2 of 25

But Jonah did NOT want to go to Nineveh! The Ninevites were **enemies** of Israel — cruel, violent people. *"Why should I warn them?"* Jonah thought. *"They deserve punishment, not mercy!"* So instead of obeying God, Jonah made a foolish decision. He decided to **run away** from God — in the exact opposite direction!

□ **PICTURE:** Jonah with a stubborn, angry expression turning his back on the direction of Nineveh (shown as a distant walled city). He's walking the opposite way with a travel bag. A signpost showing "Nineveh □" while Jonah goes left. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 3 of 25

Jonah hurried to the port city of **Joppa** where he found a ship heading to **Tarshish** — as far from Nineveh as possible! He paid the fare and went **down** into the bottom of the ship. He thought he could hide from God! He settled in and fell into a deep sleep, thinking his problems were behind him.

□ **PICTURE:** *Busy ancient port with a large wooden sailing ship. Jonah hurrying up the gangplank, looking over his shoulder nervously. Sailors loading cargo. Blue Mediterranean sea. Port city of Joppa with stone buildings. East African/Eritrean features on Jonah. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

But you **cannot run from God!** The Lord sent a **terrible, violent storm** upon the sea! The wind howled like a thousand wolves. Waves rose as tall as mountains, crashing over the ship. The wooden vessel creaked and groaned as if it would break apart any moment. The sky turned black as midnight!

□ **PICTURE:** *A massive storm at sea — enormous dark waves towering over a small wooden ship. Lightning flashing across black clouds. The ship tilting dangerously. Rain pouring sideways. Terrifying, dramatic scene. Dark blues and purples. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with dramatic atmosphere.*

Scene 5 of 25

The experienced sailors were **terrified** — and these were men who lived on the sea! They had never seen a storm this fierce! Each one cried out to their own gods for help. They threw cargo overboard to lighten the ship. *"We're going to die!"* they screamed. But nothing helped. The storm only grew worse!

□ **PICTURE:** *Terrified sailors on deck throwing wooden crates and barrels overboard. Some on their knees praying to various idols. Waves splashing over the deck. Ropes whipping in the wind. Faces twisted with fear. Dark dramatic lighting. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 6 of 25

Meanwhile, Jonah was **fast asleep** in the bottom of the ship! The captain found him and was furious: *"How can you sleep?! Get up and pray to your God! Maybe He will save us!"* The sailors then cast **lots** to find out who had caused this disaster. And the lot fell on... **Jonah!**

□ **PICTURE:** *The ship's captain shaking Jonah awake in the dark hull of the ship. Jonah looking startled and guilty. Water leaking through the wooden planks. Lantern swinging wildly. Then sailors casting lots (small stones) on deck — all pointing at Jonah. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 7 of 25

All eyes turned to Jonah. *"Who are you? What have you done?!"* they demanded. Jonah hung his head in shame and confessed: *"I am a Hebrew. I worship the Lord God who made the sea and the land. He told me to go to Nineveh... but I am running away from Him."* The sailors were even more terrified! *"What have you done to us?!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *Jonah standing in the middle of angry, frightened sailors who surround him demanding answers. Jonah's head bowed in shame and guilt. Storm raging around the ship. Lightning illuminating the scene. East African/Eritrean features on Jonah. Tense confrontation. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 8 of 25

"Throw me into the sea," Jonah said quietly. *"This storm is my fault. If you throw me overboard, the sea will become calm."* The sailors didn't want to do it — they tried rowing harder instead! But the storm was too powerful. Finally, with a prayer to God for forgiveness, they lifted Jonah and threw him into the raging waves!

□ **PICTURE:** *Dramatic moment: sailors lifting Jonah and throwing him over the ship's railing into the churning dark sea. Jonah falling through the air toward massive waves. Sailors looking away with guilt. Spray of white water. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

The **instant** Jonah hit the water — the storm stopped! The wind died. The waves calmed. The sea became as smooth as glass. The sailors stood in stunned silence, staring at the peaceful sea. They were so amazed that they feared the Lord greatly and offered sacrifices to Him. But what about Jonah, sinking in the deep dark water?

□ **PICTURE:** *Split scene: above water showing calm peaceful sea with relieved sailors on still ship under clear sky. Below waterline showing Jonah sinking down into the deep blue-green water, bubbles around him, seaweed below. Dramatic contrast. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 10 of 25

As Jonah sank deeper and deeper into the cold dark sea, God sent a **great big fish** — enormous, bigger than anything Jonah had ever seen! Its mouth opened wide like a cave, and in one great gulp — **SWOOSH!** — the fish swallowed Jonah whole! He didn't chew him — Jonah was alive inside the belly of the giant fish!

□ **PICTURE:** *A massive whale-like fish with mouth wide open, swallowing Jonah who is falling into it. Underwater scene with shafts of light from above. The fish is enormous compared to Jonah. Schools of small fish swimming away in fright. Deep ocean blues and greens. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 11 of 25

For **three days and three nights**, Jonah was inside the belly of that great fish! It was dark, slimy, and smelly. Seaweed was wrapped around his head. He could hear the fish's heartbeat. He could feel it swimming through the ocean. In that dark, strange place, Jonah finally had time to think about what he had done.

□ **PICTURE:** *Inside the belly of the great fish — dark, moist, organic-looking interior. Jonah sitting curled up with seaweed in his hair, looking miserable and thoughtful. Faint blue-green light filtering in. Ribbed walls of the fish's belly. Surreal, mysterious atmosphere. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 12 of 25

In that dark belly, Jonah finally cried out to God! He prayed the most sincere, heartfelt prayer of his life: *"Lord, I called out in my distress and You heard me! From the depths of the grave I cried — You listened! I was drowning, seaweed wrapped around me, waters closing over my head. But You, Lord, brought my life up from the pit! I will do what I promised. Salvation belongs to the Lord!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *Jonah on his knees inside the fish's belly, hands raised upward in desperate prayer. Tears streaming down his face. A beam of divine golden light breaking through the darkness, illuminating his face. Deep repentance and faith visible. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 13 of 25

God heard Jonah's prayer! The Lord commanded the great fish, and it swam toward the shore. Then with a mighty heave — **WHOOOOSH!** — the fish vomited Jonah out onto dry land! Jonah tumbled onto the

sandy beach, covered in slime but **alive!** He lay there gasping, looking up at the beautiful blue sky, so grateful to be free!

□ **PICTURE:** *The great fish near the shore with mouth wide open, Jonah being projected out onto a sandy beach. Splash of water and seaweed around him. Jonah on hands and knees on the sand, looking relieved and grateful. Bright sunny day. Beach with palm trees. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 14 of 25

Then the word of the Lord came to Jonah a **second time**: *"Get up, Jonah. Go to the great city of Nineveh and preach the message I give you."* This time — no running! No excuses! Jonah stood up immediately, brushed off the sand and seaweed, and set his face toward Nineveh. He had learned his lesson!

□ **PICTURE:** *Jonah standing on the beach, determined expression, facing toward the horizon where a distant city (Nineveh) is visible. Sun behind him. His clothes still damp but he's standing tall and resolute. A path stretching before him. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 15 of 25

Jonah walked and walked until he reached the great city of **Nineveh**. It was ENORMOUS — it took three full days just to walk across it!

Massive walls, towering buildings, and hundreds of thousands of people. These were the fearsome **Assyrians** — the most powerful and feared warriors in the world. But Jonah walked in bravely.

□ **PICTURE:** *The great walled city of Nineveh with enormous gates. Jonah (small figure) walking through the massive city gates. Assyrian architecture — winged bulls, towering walls, bustling streets. Thousands of people in the marketplace. Impressive ancient city. East African/Eritrean features on Jonah. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 16 of 25

Jonah walked through the streets preaching God's message boldly: **"In forty days, Nineveh will be destroyed!"** His voice rang out through the marketplaces, the temples, the neighborhoods. People stopped what they were doing. They looked at this strange prophet with his powerful words. Something in his voice made them tremble — they knew this was the truth.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jonah standing on elevated steps in the city center, arms raised, preaching to a growing crowd. His voice seems to echo. People stopping mid-activity — merchants, soldiers, women, children — all turning to listen. Nineveh's buildings towering around. East African/Eritrean features on Jonah. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 17 of 25

Something **miraculous** happened! The people of Nineveh actually **believed God's message!** From the poorest beggar to the richest noble, everyone began to weep and repent! They put on rough sackcloth and sat in ashes as a sign of sorrow. They cried out to God: *"We are sorry for our wickedness! Please have mercy on us!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *Crowds of Ninevites in sackcloth, kneeling in the streets, weeping and praying. Ashes on their heads. Rich and poor side by side repenting. Children clinging to parents. The whole city transformed from proud to humble. Emotional mass repentance scene. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

When word reached the **King of Nineveh**, even he got off his royal throne, removed his royal robes, put on sackcloth, and sat in ashes! He declared: *"Let no person or animal eat or drink! Everyone must cry out to God and turn from violence! Perhaps God will relent and spare us!"* The entire city fasted and prayed!

□ **PICTURE:** *The mighty King of Assyria/Nineveh stepping down from his ornate throne, removing his crown and royal robes. Putting on rough sackcloth. Sitting in ashes on the floor. Royal advisors and servants also in sackcloth. Dramatic transformation of power to humility. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

God saw their sincere repentance — that they truly turned from their evil ways. And in His great **mercy and compassion**, God relented! He did NOT destroy Nineveh! Over 120,000 people were saved because they listened to God's warning and repented. God's heart is always ready to forgive those who genuinely turn back to Him.

□ **PICTURE:** *Golden divine light shining down over the city of Nineveh. People looking up with relief and joy, tears of gratitude. Dark storm clouds rolling away, replaced by sunshine. The city spared — alive and grateful. Hands raised in thanksgiving. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with divine radiance.*

Scene 20 of 25

But Jonah was **angry!** He sat outside the city pouting: *"I KNEW it! I knew You would forgive them! That's why I ran to Tarshish! You are gracious, compassionate, slow to anger and abounding in love! I would rather die than see these enemies forgiven!"* Jonah was so upset that God showed mercy to people he considered enemies.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jonah sitting alone on a hill outside Nineveh, arms crossed, scowling at the saved city. Red-faced with anger. The city peaceful and whole below him. Contrast between God's joy and Jonah's bitterness. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 21 of 25

God caused a **leafy plant** to grow up overnight, giving Jonah shade from the hot sun. Jonah was delighted! But the next morning, God sent a worm to eat the plant, and it withered. Then God sent a scorching east wind and blazing sun. Jonah was miserable, sweating and suffering. *"I'm angry enough to die!"* he complained.

□ **PICTURE:** *Two-part scene: First, Jonah smiling happily under a large green leafy vine/plant giving shade. Second, the same plant withered and dead with a small worm, Jonah under blazing sun looking miserable, wiping sweat. Desert hillside setting. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

Then God spoke tenderly but firmly: *"Jonah, you are upset about a plant you did not grow or tend. It lived one night and died the next. But Nineveh has more than **120,000 people** who don't know right from wrong — plus many animals! Should I not be concerned about that great city?"* God was teaching Jonah about **compassion** — that every person matters to God, even our enemies.

□ **PICTURE:** *God's gentle light shining on Jonah who sits with the withered plant, his expression softening as he begins to understand. Below, a panoramic view of Nineveh with thousands of small figures — men, women,*

and children — going about their lives. God's love encompassing them all. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | ባሕርይ

Jonah's story reminds us of something powerful: **we cannot run from God, and God's mercy is for everyone.** Jonah tried to run but ended up in a fish's belly! God gave him a second chance, and He gives us second chances too. But the deepest lesson is this: God loves ALL people — even those we consider enemies. His compassion has no boundaries, and neither should ours.

🖼️ **PICTURE:** *A reflective montage: Jonah running, the storm, inside the fish praying, preaching in Nineveh, and finally understanding God's compassion. A heart shape containing the whole world — all kinds of people. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with warm message of universal love.*

Scene 24 of 25 — ባሕርይ | In Tigrigna

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Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | 📖📖📖📖

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You cannot run from God, and God's love is for everyone — even those we think don't deserve it. Jonah learned the hard way that disobedience leads to trouble, but God gives second chances! Most importantly, God cares about ALL people. His compassion has no limits. When God asks us to love others — even those who have hurt us — He means it! Forgiveness and mercy are God's heart.

Key Virtues: Obedience, Repentance, Compassion, Mercy, Second Chances, Universal Love, Humility

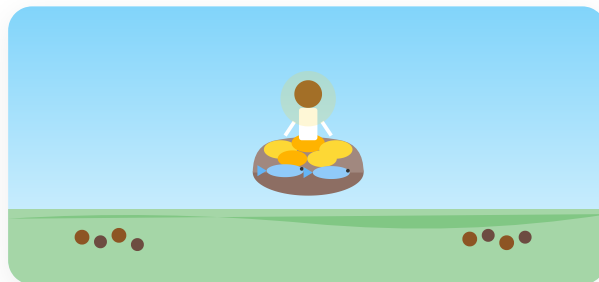
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8

Five Loaves and Two Fish

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□ John 6:1–14 | □□□□ 6:1–14



Scene 1 of 25

Jesus had been teaching and healing the sick all day long. Wherever He went, crowds followed Him — thousands and thousands of people! They came from every village, every town, climbing hills and crossing fields just to hear His words and see His miracles. On this day, over **5,000 men** (plus women and children!) had gathered on a hillside near the Sea of Galilee.

□ **PICTURE:** *Massive crowd of over 5,000 people gathered on a green hillside near a blue lake (Sea of Galilee). Jesus visible at the center/front teaching. People of all ages sitting on the grass. East African/Eritrean features. Beautiful pastoral landscape. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 2 of 25

The sun began to sink lower in the sky. The golden afternoon was fading. The people had been listening to Jesus all day — their stomachs were rumbling! Children tugged on their parents' sleeves: *"I'm hungry, Mama!"* There were no markets nearby, no food stalls — they were in a remote, grassy place far from any town.

□ **PICTURE:** *Evening golden light over the hillside crowd. A child holding their stomach looking up at their mother. Setting sun painting the sky orange and pink. People looking tired but content from listening. Remote grassy hillside with no buildings in sight. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 3 of 25

The disciples came to Jesus looking worried. *"Master, it's getting late and this place is remote. Send the people away so they can go to nearby villages and buy food for themselves,"* they said practically. They saw the problem clearly but could not imagine a solution. How do you feed thousands of people with nothing?

□ **PICTURE:** *Disciples gathered around Jesus, gesturing toward the crowd and the setting sun. Worried expressions on their faces. Jesus sitting calmly, listening. The vast crowd stretching across the hillside behind them. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

But Jesus smiled and said something that shocked them: **"You feed them."** The disciples' eyes went wide! Philip exclaimed, *"Even if we worked for eight months, we couldn't earn enough money to give each person even a small bite!"* It seemed absolutely impossible. But Jesus already knew exactly what He was going to do.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus with a knowing smile, pointing at His shocked disciples. Philip with hands up in disbelief, mouth open. Other disciples looking at each other in confusion. The enormous crowd visible in background. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with humorous shock on disciples' faces.*

Scene 5 of 25

Then **Andrew**, Simon Peter's brother, came forward with someone special — a young boy! Andrew said, *"There is a boy here who has five small barley loaves and two small fish..."* He paused and looked at the massive crowd. *"...but what good are these among so many people?"* It seemed like a silly, hopeless offering.

□ **PICTURE:** Andrew (disciple) leading a young boy by the hand toward Jesus. The boy is small, maybe 8-10 years old, carrying a small woven basket/lunch bundle. Andrew gesturing apologetically. Jesus watching with warm interest. Crowd in background. East African/Eritrean features on the boy. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 6 of 25

The little boy looked up at Jesus with big, trusting eyes. His lunch was small — just **five little barley loaves** (the bread of poor people) and **two tiny dried fish**. It was barely enough for one child! But this boy had a generous heart. He held out his lunch to Jesus willingly: *"You can have it all!"*

□ **PICTURE:** Close-up of the young boy holding up his small lunch toward Jesus — five small round flatbreads and two tiny dried fish in a simple cloth. The boy's face is eager and generous, eyes bright. Jesus reaching down toward the offering with a warm smile. East African/Eritrean features on boy. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 7 of 25

Jesus took the boy's small lunch with great reverence, as if it were the most precious treasure in the world. He smiled at the boy warmly. Then He told the disciples: *"Have the people sit down in groups."* The crowd sat down on the soft green grass — groups of fifty, groups of a hundred — a beautiful sight like a garden of people!

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus holding the small basket of food, looking upward. The enormous crowd organizing themselves into neat groups on the green hillside, sitting on grass. Disciples directing people. Beautiful orderly arrangement. Evening golden light. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 8 of 25

Then Jesus did something beautiful. He looked up to heaven, and **gave thanks** to God the Father. His prayer was simple but powerful — thanking God for this small offering, believing that God could do the impossible. Even before the miracle happened, Jesus gave thanks! He showed us that gratitude comes before the blessing.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus standing, holding the bread and fish up toward heaven, eyes closed in prayer of thanksgiving. Divine golden light streaming down on Him. The food glowing slightly. Thousands watching in silence. A holy, sacred moment. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

Then the **miracle** began! Jesus broke the bread and — it kept coming! He broke off piece after piece, and the bread **never ran out!** The fish multiplied in His hands! More and more and more appeared! The disciples' eyes grew wider with each piece. This was impossible — yet it was happening right before their eyes!

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus breaking bread with His hands, and the bread miraculously multiplying — pieces appearing and overflowing. Golden glow around the bread. Fish multiplying beside it. Disciples watching with mouths open in amazement, arms full of food. Miracle in action. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 10 of 25

Jesus handed the multiplied food to His disciples, and they began passing it out to the crowd. Basket after basket was filled! The disciples ran back and forth — from Jesus to the people, from Jesus to the people. Every time they returned, there was more! The food supply was **endless**, flowing from Jesus' hands like a river!

□ **PICTURE:** *Disciples carrying overflowing baskets of bread and fish, distributing to the crowd. People reaching up to receive food with joyful faces. Multiple disciples visible carrying baskets in different directions. Abundance and movement. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 11 of 25

Everywhere across that hillside, people were **eating!** Fathers broke bread with their children. Mothers fed their little ones. Friends shared together, laughing with amazement. *"Where did all this food come from?" "It's a miracle!" "This bread is delicious!"* Joy and wonder filled the air like music!

□ **PICTURE:** Joyful scene of families eating together on the green hillside. Children biting into bread with happy faces. Mothers feeding toddlers. Groups laughing and talking in amazement. Bread and fish visible everywhere. Warm evening light. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 12 of 25

Every single person ate until they were **completely full!** Not just a bite, not just a taste — they were SATISFIED! Over 5,000 men plus all the women and children — perhaps 15,000 or 20,000 people total — all fed from one boy's tiny lunch! Nobody was left hungry. The God who feeds the birds feeds His children even more!

□ **PICTURE:** Satisfied people leaning back on the grass, patting their full bellies. Children lying down contentedly. Smiles everywhere. The hillside peaceful and content. Empty bread fragments around. Stars beginning to appear in darkening sky. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 13 of 25

After everyone had eaten, Jesus told His disciples: "*Gather up the pieces that are left over. Let nothing be wasted.*" The disciples went through the crowd with baskets, picking up the leftover pieces of bread and fish. And how much was left over? **Twelve full baskets!**

They started with 5 loaves and 2 fish — and ended with MORE than they began!

□ **PICTURE:** *Disciples collecting leftover bread pieces into large wicker baskets. Twelve baskets overflowing with food fragments, arranged in a row. Disciples amazed, counting the baskets. More food left over than they started with! Evening hillside scene. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 14 of 25

The people were absolutely amazed! They said to each other: *"Surely this is the Prophet who was to come into the world!"* The little boy who shared his lunch stood there grinning from ear to ear — his small gift in Jesus' hands had fed a multitude! He would never forget this day as long as he lived.

□ **PICTURE:** *The young boy standing among the crowd, beaming with pride and joy. People around him pointing at him and smiling — "That's the boy with the lunch!" Jesus placing His hand on the boy's head in blessing. Stars appearing in twilight sky. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 15 of 25

What a beautiful picture this gives us! The boy could have kept his lunch for himself — after all, it was just a small meal. He could have

thought, *"What difference can MY little lunch make?"* But he gave it freely, willingly, joyfully to Jesus. And Jesus took something small and made it **abundantly** more than enough!

□ **PICTURE:** Symbolic illustration: a child's small open hands holding a tiny offering at the bottom, and above Jesus' hands transforming it into an abundance — bread and fish overflowing like a waterfall of blessing. Golden light connecting the two. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 16 of 25

This miracle teaches us that **nothing is too small for God to use**. You might think you're too young, or your gift is too small, or you don't have enough to make a difference. But when you put what you have in Jesus' hands — whether it's your time, your talent, your kindness, or even just your lunch — He can multiply it beyond your imagination!

□ **PICTURE:** Children of different ages offering various things to Jesus — one offering a drawing, another offering help to an elderly person, another sharing a toy. Jesus receiving each gift with joy. Multiplication imagery — small seeds becoming big trees. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 17 of 25

Think about it — the disciples wanted to **send people away**. They saw the problem as too big. *"We can't afford this! It's impossible!"* But Jesus never turns people away. He never says the problem is too big. Instead, He asked: *"What do you have?"* He works with what we bring Him, no matter how small!

□ **PICTURE:** *Split scene: on one side, disciples with empty hands shrugging hopelessly. On the other side, Jesus with arms open wide welcoming the crowd. Between them, the tiny basket of fish and bread glowing with potential. Contrast between human doubt and divine possibility. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

And why twelve baskets left over? Jesus had **twelve disciples**! It was as if God was saying to each one: *"See? I am more than enough. Here's a basket for each of you to carry — proof that I can do abundantly more than you can ask or imagine!"* God doesn't just meet our needs — He overflows!

□ **PICTURE:** *Twelve disciples each holding a full basket, looking at each other in wonder. Jesus standing among them with arms spread wide, smiling. The number 12 emphasized — twelve men, twelve baskets. Golden abundance. Evening sky with first stars. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

Jesus later said, ***"I am the Bread of Life. Whoever comes to Me will never go hungry, and whoever believes in Me will never be thirsty."***

The miracle of the loaves wasn't just about physical food — it pointed to something greater. Jesus Himself is the ultimate gift who satisfies our deepest hunger — our hunger for love, purpose, and hope.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus with arms outstretched, glowing with warm light, speaking to the crowd. Above Him, the words "Bread of Life" in golden script. People reaching toward Him with longing. Bread symbolism woven throughout. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with spiritual depth.*

Scene 20 of 25

The boy went home that night and told his mother everything!

"Mama! I gave Jesus my lunch and He fed THOUSANDS of people with it!"

His mother hugged him tight: ***"My generous boy! God used your willing heart!"*** That boy learned the most important lesson: **generosity +**

Jesus = miracles!

□ **PICTURE:** *The boy running home excitedly, jumping into his mother's arms. His mother hugging him with pride. A humble home with warm lamplight. The boy animated, telling his story with big gestures. Mother's face beaming. Stars visible through the window. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 21 of 25

This was one of Jesus' most famous miracles — recorded in **all four Gospels!** Matthew, Mark, Luke, and John all told this story because its message is so important: God can take your small offering and turn it into a world-changing blessing. Never underestimate what God can do through a willing, generous heart.

□ **PICTURE:** *Four open scrolls/books representing the four Gospels, each showing a drawing of the miracle. In the center, the original five loaves and two fish with radiating golden light. Doves flying around representing the Holy Spirit inspiring the writers. East African/Eritrean features in illustrations. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

Remember: the miracle didn't start with Jesus having everything — it started with a child offering something small. **YOUR** smile can brighten someone's day. **YOUR** kindness can change someone's life. **YOUR** willingness to share can start a miracle! You don't need to be rich, strong, or old to be used by God. Just be willing — and watch what Jesus does!

□ **PICTURE:** *Modern-day children performing acts of kindness — sharing food, helping carry bags, giving flowers to elderly, reading to younger children. Each act glowing with golden light showing it's a miracle in the*

making. Diverse East African/Eritrean children. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | ባሕርይ

What do you have in your hands today? Maybe it feels small and insignificant. Maybe you think, "I'm just a kid — what can I do?" But remember the boy with five loaves and two fish! He didn't have much, but he had a **willing heart**. And that's all Jesus needs. Give Him what you have — your time, your kindness, your talent, your love — and watch Him multiply it into something beautiful!

🖼️ **PICTURE:** *A child looking down at their open hands, wondering what they have to offer. Then looking up to see Jesus smiling warmly, reaching out. A golden glow between their hands and Jesus, representing faith and willingness. Simple but powerful. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 24 of 25 — ባሕርይ | In Tigrigna

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“But what if I don't have anything?” — 5 people asked 2 people who said, “You
don't have anything?” The two people said, “We don't have anything either!”
“But what if I don't have anything?” — 5 people asked 2 people who said, “You
don't have anything?” The two people said, “We don't have anything either!”
“But what if I don't have anything?” — 12 people asked 2 people who said, “You
don't have anything?” The two people said, “We don't have anything either!”

Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | 00000

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Even the smallest gift matters when you give it to Jesus! A boy's tiny lunch fed over 5,000 people because he was willing to share! You are never too small, too young, or too poor to be used by God. Whatever you have — give it with a willing heart, and watch God multiply it into something amazing! Generosity unlocks miracles.

Key Virtues: Generosity, Willingness, Faith, Sharing, Gratitude, Trust in God, Selflessness

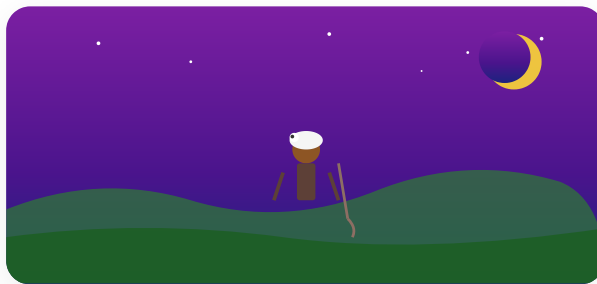
“But what if I don't have anything?” — 5,000+ people asked! “You don't have anything?” — 5,000+ people asked! “You don't have anything?” — 5,000+ people asked!

9

📖 The Lost Sheep

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📖 Luke 15:1–7 | 📖📖 15:1–7



Scene 1 of 25

One day, **Jesus** was surrounded by people who were considered sinners and outcasts — tax collectors, people who had made bad choices, those whom the religious leaders looked down upon. But Jesus welcomed them warmly! He sat with them, ate with them, and loved them. The Pharisees grumbled: *"This man eats with sinners!"* So Jesus told them this beautiful story...

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus sitting among a diverse group of humble people — tax collectors, common folk, outcasts. He's smiling and engaging with them warmly. In the background, Pharisees in fancy robes whispering and scowling disapprovingly. Contrast between Jesus' warmth and the Pharisees' coldness. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 2 of 25

"Imagine," Jesus said, *"a shepherd who has **one hundred sheep**."*

Picture a kind, strong shepherd on beautiful green hills. He knows every single one of his sheep by name! He knows which one has the spot on its ear, which one likes to play, which one is shy. He loves each one deeply — they are his treasure.

□ **PICTURE:** *A kind, strong shepherd standing on a lush green hillside, surrounded by 100 white fluffy sheep. He's gently touching one sheep's head. Rolling green hills, blue sky with white clouds. Peaceful pastoral scene. The shepherd has East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 3 of 25

Every morning, the good shepherd leads his flock to green pastures and still waters. He walks ahead of them, and they follow his voice. He protects them from wolves, from lions, from thorns and cliffs. At evening, he brings them safely into the fold and counts them one by

one: "...*ninety-seven, ninety-eight, ninety-nine...*" He stops. His face changes. **One is missing!**

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd at the entrance of a stone sheep pen at twilight, counting sheep as they file in. His finger pointing as he counts. His expression changing from calm to alarmed. Orange sunset sky. Sheep entering the fold one by one. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

The shepherd counts again — ninety-seven, ninety-eight, ninety-nine. Only **ninety-nine!** His heart pounds. Which one is missing? He knows instantly — it's the little one, the adventurous one who always wanders too far! Night is falling. Wolves are hunting. Danger is everywhere. He doesn't hesitate for even one second — he must find that sheep!

□ **PICTURE:** *Close-up of the shepherd's worried face, eyes scanning the dark hills. One hand clutching his staff, the other shielding his eyes as he searches the darkening landscape. Behind him in the pen, 99 sheep safe together. Dramatic evening sky turning dark. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 5 of 25

Jesus said, "*He leaves the ninety-nine in the open country and goes after the lost sheep.*" Think about that! Ninety-nine safe sheep — but this shepherd cannot rest knowing **one** is lost! He doesn't say, "Oh well, I still have ninety-nine." No! Every single one matters. He makes the ninety-nine secure and sets out into the darkness alone.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd leaving the safe fold behind, walking alone into the dark wilderness with only his staff and a small oil lamp. Behind him, 99 sheep safe in the stone pen. Before him, dark hills, shadowy valleys, unknown dangers. Brave determination on his face. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 6 of 25

The shepherd searches through dark valleys where shadows hide dangers. He climbs steep rocky hills, his sandals slipping on loose stones. Thorns scratch his arms and legs. The wind howls cold against his face. He doesn't care about his own comfort — all he can think about is his lost little sheep, alone and afraid somewhere in the darkness.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd climbing a steep rocky hillside in darkness, thorns catching his cloak. His lamp held high, casting small pool of light. Dark shadows all around. Rocky terrain, dangerous cliff edges. Scratches on his hands. Determined expression despite difficulty. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 7 of 25

Through the darkness, the shepherd calls out: **"Little one! Where are you? Come to my voice!"** His voice echoes across the empty hills. He listens carefully for any sound — a bleat, a cry, anything! But the wind carries his words away into silence. Still, he does not give up. He keeps walking, keeps searching, keeps calling.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd cupping his hands around his mouth, calling out into the vast dark landscape. His voice visualized as waves of sound spreading into the night. Stars above, dark hills around. Alone in the wilderness. His face showing love and determination. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 8 of 25

Hours pass. His legs are tired. His body aches. Wolves howl in the distance — their yellow eyes flickering in the darkness. But the good shepherd doesn't turn back! He would face any danger for his sheep. He presses forward through thick bushes, crosses cold streams, and climbs higher and higher into the mountains.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd crossing a cold mountain stream at night, water up to his knees. In the background, pairs of glowing yellow wolf eyes visible in the darkness. The shepherd gripping his staff protectively, pressing forward bravely. Moonlight reflecting on water. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

Then — faintly — he hears it! A weak, frightened *"Baa... baa..."* coming from somewhere below! His heart leaps! He rushes toward the sound, scrambling over rocks. And there, on a narrow cliff ledge over a deep ravine, he sees it — his little lost sheep! It's trembling, trapped, too scared to move, its wool caught in thorns.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd peering over a cliff edge, his lamp illuminating a small white sheep stuck on a narrow ledge below. The sheep trembling, wool tangled in thorny bushes, looking up with frightened eyes. Deep dark ravine below. Dramatic scene of discovery. East African/Eritrean features on shepherd. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 10 of 25

The shepherd doesn't scold the sheep! He doesn't say, *"Stupid sheep! Why did you wander off?!"* No — his eyes fill with **tears of joy!** *"I found you! I found you, little one! Don't be afraid — I'm here now!"* His voice is gentle, soothing, full of love. The sheep recognizes its shepherd's voice and stops trembling.

□ **PICTURE:** *Close-up of the shepherd's face — tears of joy streaming down, the most loving smile. He's reaching down toward the scared sheep on the ledge. The sheep looking up recognizing its master, calming down. Beautiful emotional connection between shepherd and sheep. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 11 of 25

Carefully, gently, the shepherd climbs down to the ledge. He frees the sheep's wool from the thorns. He checks its legs — not broken! He wraps his own cloak around it for warmth. Then with strong, loving arms, he **lifts the sheep onto his shoulders**. The sheep rests its head against the shepherd's neck, safe at last.

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd carefully lifting the small sheep onto his broad shoulders. The sheep draped across his shoulders, relaxed and safe, head resting near the shepherd's head. Shepherd smiling with pure joy. Stars twinkling above. Cloak wrapped around the sheep. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 12 of 25

The shepherd carries the sheep all the way home on his shoulders — not making it walk, even though it was the sheep who wandered off! He bears the full weight with joy. His steps are light even though his body is tired, because his heart is **overflowing with happiness**. The lost one is found! Every step home is a step of celebration!

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd walking home through the hills under starlight, sheep comfortably on his shoulders. A spring in his step despite the long night. Moonlight lighting his path home. The shepherd humming happily. Green hills in soft moonlight. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 13 of 25

When the shepherd arrives home, he doesn't quietly put the sheep back and go to sleep. No! He calls together his friends and neighbors: **"Rejoice with me! I have found my lost sheep!"** The whole community celebrates! Lamps are lit, songs are sung, there is laughter and joy! One sheep was lost — and now it's found!

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd arriving at his village, holding up the found sheep triumphantly. Neighbors and friends coming out of houses with lamps, celebrating, clapping, smiling. Children running toward the shepherd excitedly. Festive joyful atmosphere. Night scene with warm lamplight. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 14 of 25

Then Jesus revealed the beautiful meaning: **"I tell you, there will be more rejoicing in heaven over ONE sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent!"** The whole point was this — every time someone who is lost turns back to God, the angels in heaven throw a PARTY! YOU matter that much to God!

□ **PICTURE:** *Split scene: Jesus telling the parable to the crowd below, and above in heaven, angels celebrating joyfully — dancing, singing, playing instruments, rejoicing. Golden heavenly light contrasting with earthly scene.*

The Pharisees looking shocked at this teaching. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 15 of 25

Think about what this means for **you!** You are not just one of billions — you are known, named, and loved individually by God. If YOU were the only person on earth, Jesus would still have come for you! You are not a number to God. You are His precious child. He knows your name, your fears, your dreams — and He loves every part of you.

□ **PICTURE:** *A single child standing in a vast green field, looking small. Then Jesus kneeling down to be at the child's eye level, His full attention on this one child. No crowd — just personal, intimate love. Golden light surrounding both. East African/Eritrean features on the child. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 16 of 25

The Pharisees thought God only loved "good people" — those who followed all the rules perfectly. But Jesus shattered that idea! God's love **actively seeks** those who are lost. He doesn't sit in heaven waiting for you to find your way — He comes down, He searches, He calls your name. He is the Good Shepherd who leaves comfort to find you!

□ **PICTURE:** *Contrast scene: Pharisees behind a wall looking judgmental and exclusive. On the other side, Jesus with arms wide open, walking toward people who are lost, hurting, ashamed. Barrier being broken. Light flowing from Jesus toward the lost. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 17 of 25

Notice that the shepherd didn't punish the sheep for wandering. He didn't hit it or yell at it. Instead, he **carried it home with joy!** That's how God treats us when we mess up and come back to Him. He doesn't hold grudges. He doesn't say, "I told you so!" He says, *"Welcome home, my beloved! I missed you!"*

□ **PICTURE:** *The shepherd sitting with the found sheep in his lap, gently cleaning its wounds, removing thorns from its wool. Pure gentleness and care. The sheep looking up at the shepherd with trust. A warm home setting with soft firelight. East African/Eritrean features on shepherd. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

Jesus later said, **"I am the Good Shepherd. The Good Shepherd lays down His life for the sheep."** This parable was pointing to Himself! Jesus is the Shepherd, and WE are His sheep. He left the glory of heaven to come find us when we were lost. He would rather die than lose even one of His precious sheep.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus as the Good Shepherd, standing protectively in front of a flock of sheep, arms outstretched shielding them from danger. Behind Him, shadows of wolves/darkness. He's willing to stand between His sheep and any threat. Divine glow around Him. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

Have you ever felt lost? Maybe lost in sadness, lost in fear, lost in loneliness? Maybe you did something wrong and felt too ashamed to come back to God? Listen — the Good Shepherd is **already searching for you!** He is calling your name right now. You don't have to find your way alone. Just cry out, and He will come!

□ **PICTURE:** *A child sitting alone in darkness looking sad and lost. But behind them, a warm figure (Jesus the Shepherd) approaching with outstretched hand and a gentle glowing light, about to reach them. Hope breaking through darkness. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 20 of 25

And here's something even more wonderful — God doesn't just want to find you, He wants to **celebrate you!** The shepherd threw a party when the sheep came home! God doesn't grudgingly accept us back — He REJOICES over us! *"The Lord your God is with you. He takes great*

delight in you. He will quiet you with His love. He will rejoice over you with singing!"

□ **PICTURE:** Joyful celebration scene — God's love represented as warm golden light enveloping a child who is being welcomed home. Angels with instruments playing music. Flowers blooming, colors bursting. Pure joy and celebration. The child being embraced. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 21 of 25

This story also teaches us how we should treat others. Just as the shepherd went after the one lost sheep, **we should care about people who are lost, lonely, or left out.** The new kid at school, the child sitting alone at lunch, the person everyone ignores — they are the "one" sheep! Will you be like the shepherd and go to them?

□ **PICTURE:** Children in a schoolyard — one child sitting alone while others play. Then another child (inspired by the story) walking over to the lonely child with a smile and extending their hand in friendship. Kindness in action. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 22 of 25

The Good Shepherd knows His sheep and His sheep know His voice. He calls each one by name. He leads them to green pastures and beside still waters. He restores their souls. Even when they walk

through the darkest valley, they need not fear — for He is with them. His rod and staff comfort them. **Goodness and mercy follow them all the days of their lives!**

□ **PICTURE:** Peaceful, beautiful scene: the Good Shepherd leading sheep through lush green meadows beside a calm, crystal-clear stream. Flowers blooming everywhere. Perfect peace and safety. Sheep following contentedly. Psalm 23 imagery. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | □□□□□□

What a beautiful picture of God's love! He isn't satisfied with ninety-nine when one is missing. He isn't too busy, too tired, or too important to come looking for the lost. And He doesn't send someone else — He comes **Himself!** You are the reason Jesus came to earth. You are the sheep He would cross mountains to find. You are worth the search, the sacrifice, and the celebration!

□ **PICTURE:** A heart-shaped frame containing the shepherd carrying the sheep on his shoulders, walking toward a glowing home in the distance. Around the frame, words: "You are worth finding." Stars and gentle light. Warm, comforting, hopeful image. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 24 of 25 — □□□□□□ | In Tigrigna

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Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ

ᐱᐱ Moral Lesson | ᐱᐱᐱᐱᐱ ᐱᐱᐱᐱ

You are never too lost for God to find you! Like the good shepherd who left 99 sheep to find one, God's love pursues you personally. You are not a number — you are His beloved child, known by name! And when you come home to Him, all of heaven celebrates. Also, be like the shepherd to others — notice the lonely, seek the lost, include the left out.

Key Virtues: God's Pursuing Love, Individual Worth, Compassion, Celebration, Inclusion, Persistence, Grace

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10

Jesus Calms the Storm

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□ Mark 4:35–41 | □□□□ 4:35–41



Scene 1 of 25

It had been a **long, exhausting day** for Jesus. From early morning He had been teaching thousands of people by the Sea of Galilee, telling parables about the Kingdom of God. He healed the sick, blessed children, and answered endless questions. His human body was tired — He had given everything to the crowds.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus teaching a massive crowd by the Sea of Galilee. He's visibly tired but still compassionate. Evening approaching. The crowd spread across the shoreline. Jesus sitting in a boat near the shore using it as a pulpit. Warm golden sunset beginning. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 2 of 25

As evening fell and the sky turned orange and pink, Jesus turned to His disciples and said, **"Let us cross over to the other side of the lake."** The disciples nodded — several of them were experienced fishermen who knew this lake like the back of their hands. Peter, Andrew, James, and John had grown up on these waters.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus speaking to His disciples by the lake shore at sunset, pointing across the Sea of Galilee. The disciples listening, some already heading toward their boats. Beautiful sunset colors reflected in calm water. Fishing boats lined up on shore. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 3 of 25

They got into the boat — a simple wooden fishing vessel with a single sail. The disciples pushed off from shore, and the boat glided out onto the calm, glassy water of the Sea of Galilee. The evening was peaceful. Stars were beginning to appear. Other boats followed behind them. Everything seemed perfectly safe and ordinary.

□ **PICTURE:** *A wooden fishing boat with Jesus and disciples aboard, pushing off from shore into calm peaceful water. Twilight sky with first stars. The lake serene and mirror-like. Other small boats nearby. Everything tranquil and beautiful. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 4 of 25

Jesus was so exhausted from the day's work that He went to the back of the boat, found a cushion, lay His head down, and **fell fast asleep**. Deeply, peacefully asleep. The gentle rocking of the boat and the soft splash of water were a lullaby. Even the Son of God needed rest! His human body was tired, and He slept like a child.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus sleeping peacefully on a cushion in the stern (back) of the boat. His face serene, completely at rest. A blanket or cloak over Him. The boat gently rocking. Disciples in the background managing the sail. Peaceful night beginning. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 5 of 25

Then without warning — **BOOM!** A sudden, violent storm erupted out of nowhere! The Sea of Galilee sits in a bowl of mountains, and cold winds can sweep down without warning, creating instant fury. The sky turned black. The wind screamed. This was no ordinary storm — it was as if the very forces of darkness were attacking!

□ **PICTURE:** *Sudden dramatic storm hitting the lake. Black clouds rolling in violently. The calm water transformed into chaos instantly. Wind bending the boat's mast. The transition from calm to storm captured in one dramatic image. Lightning beginning to flash. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 6 of 25

The waves were **ENORMOUS** — as tall as walls, crashing over the sides of the boat! Water poured in from every direction. The little fishing boat was tossed around like a toy in a bathtub. Up and down, side to side, the boat rode terrifying wave after wave. Spray blinded the disciples. The roar of the storm was deafening!

□ **PICTURE:** *Massive waves towering over the small boat, crashing over the sides. The boat tilted at a dangerous angle on a wave crest. White water spray everywhere. The boat looking tiny against the enormous dark waves. Terrifying power of nature. Watercolor children's Bible illustration with dramatic force.*

Scene 7 of 25

The disciples were **terrified!** And remember — Peter, Andrew, James, and John were professional fishermen! They had seen many storms in their lives. But this one was different. This storm was trying to **kill them!** Even these experienced sailors were convinced they were about to die. Their faces were white with terror!

□ **PICTURE:** *The disciples gripping the sides of the boat with white-knuckled hands. Faces showing absolute terror. Some trying to bail water frantically with buckets. Others holding onto ropes. Professional fishermen utterly overwhelmed. Waves crashing over them. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 8 of 25

Water was filling the boat faster than they could bail it out! The boat was getting heavier, sinking lower into the raging sea. *"Bail faster!"* Peter screamed over the howling wind. *"We're going down!"* John shouted, clinging to the mast. The sail had torn to shreds. Everything seemed hopeless. They were going to drown!

□ **PICTURE:** *Inside the boat — water rising to the disciples' ankles, then knees. Some desperately scooping water out with buckets and pots. Torn sail flapping wildly in the wind. The boat visibly sinking lower. Pure desperation. Dark, churning water all around. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 9 of 25

Then someone looked toward the back of the boat and couldn't believe their eyes — **Jesus was still sleeping!** In the middle of this monstrous storm, with waves crashing and death approaching, Jesus slept peacefully on His cushion! The storm didn't disturb His rest. His peace was deeper than the chaos around Him!

□ **PICTURE:** *Incredible contrast: the front of the boat in total chaos — disciples screaming, water crashing, wind howling. But in the back of the boat, Jesus peacefully sleeping on His cushion, completely undisturbed. Light around Him while darkness rages. The most striking contrast. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 10 of 25

The disciples stumbled toward Him, shaking Him awake desperately: **"Teacher! Teacher! Don't you CARE that we are DROWNING?!"** Their voices were raw with fear and frustration. **"Wake up! We're all going to die!"** They couldn't understand how He could sleep while they perished. They were terrified AND confused!

□ **PICTURE:** *Disciples shaking Jesus' shoulders urgently, their faces frantic and desperate. Mouths open shouting. Water splashing over them. Jesus' eyes just opening. The emotional intensity of their fear and their plea for help. Lightning flash illuminating the scene. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 11 of 25

Jesus opened His eyes calmly. He didn't panic. He didn't rush. He didn't look at the waves with fear. Instead, He **stood up** in that rocking, tilting, storm-tossed boat — stood up with complete authority and absolute peace. The wind whipped His robes, the waves crashed around Him, but He stood firm as a mountain.

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus rising to His feet in the boat, standing tall and steady despite the violent rocking. His robes blowing in the wind but His face completely calm and authoritative. He looks at the storm the way a king looks at a servant. Total confidence. Lightning behind Him. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 12 of 25

Then Jesus raised His hand toward the howling wind and the raging waves, and spoke with the authority of the **Creator of the universe**: **"PEACE! BE STILL!"** Just two words — but they carried the power that spoke the world into existence! The same voice that said "Let there be light" now commanded, "Be still!"

□ **PICTURE:** *The most powerful scene: Jesus with arm raised, hand outstretched toward the storm, mouth open commanding "Peace! Be still!" His words visualized as a shockwave of golden light pushing against the darkness and waves. Divine authority radiating from Him. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 13 of 25

INSTANTLY — the wind stopped! Not gradually, not slowly — **INSTANTLY!** The waves fell flat. The clouds parted. The sea became as smooth as glass in a single heartbeat. Complete, perfect, supernatural calm. The silence was almost louder than the storm had

been. Nothing in nature stops that quickly — unless God commands it!

□ **PICTURE:** *The dramatic transformation: the raging sea becoming instantly perfectly calm and mirror-like. Clouds parting to reveal stars and moonlight. The water going from chaos to glass-smooth. Before and after contrast visible. Stunned silence captured visually. Moonlight on still water. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 14 of 25

The disciples stood frozen in the boat — soaking wet, shaking — but now from **awe**, not from fear of the storm! They looked at the perfectly calm sea. They looked at each other. They looked at Jesus. Their mouths hung open. What they had just witnessed was beyond anything they could comprehend. Who WAS this man?!

□ **PICTURE:** *The disciples standing in the boat in stunned silence, dripping wet, mouths hanging open in complete awe. Wide eyes staring at Jesus, then at the impossibly calm sea. Some sinking to their knees. The boat now perfectly still on mirror-smooth water. Stars reflected in the water. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 15 of 25

They whispered to each other with trembling voices: **"Who IS this?!**
Even the wind and the waves OBEY Him!" They had seen Jesus heal

the sick and teach with wisdom. But this — commanding nature itself! Only the Creator could command creation! In that moment, they understood something new and terrifying about Jesus — He was more than a teacher. He was **God**.

□ **PICTURE:** *Disciples whispering to each other in awe-struck reverence. Some pointing at the calm sea, others pointing at Jesus. Faces showing a new level of holy fear and wonder. Jesus standing peacefully, a subtle glow around Him. Calm night, stars reflecting on perfectly still water. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 16 of 25

Then Jesus turned to His disciples with a gentle but searching question: **"Why are you so afraid? Do you still have no faith?"** His voice was not angry — it was tender, like a father teaching his children. He was asking: "I was right here with you the whole time. Did you really think I would let you drown? Don't you know who I am?"

□ **PICTURE:** *Jesus looking at His disciples with gentle, loving eyes — not angry, but teaching. His expression showing mild concern at their lack of faith. Disciples looking down with a mix of shame and wonder. The calm sea and starry sky behind them. Intimate moment of teaching. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 17 of 25

Think about it — the One who **created** the sea was IN the boat! The One who formed the wind with His breath was sleeping on the cushion! They had the Master of the universe with them, yet they panicked as if they were alone. Jesus wanted them to understand: **if He is with you, no storm can destroy you!**

□ **PICTURE:** *Symbolic illustration: Jesus at the center of a boat, and around the boat, the universe He created — stars, planets, oceans, mountains — all formed by His word. Showing that the Creator of all was their passenger. Divine majesty combined with humble presence. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 18 of 25

This story teaches us something profound about **our own storms**. We all face storms in life — sickness, fear, family problems, bullies, loneliness, loss. Sometimes it feels like our boat is sinking and God is sleeping. We cry out, "**Don't you care?!**" But Jesus IS in your boat! He hasn't abandoned you. He is never asleep to your pain.

□ **PICTURE:** *Modern-day child facing their own "storms" — represented as dark swirling clouds of worry, fear, and sadness around them. But Jesus visible in the storm with them, hand reaching toward the child. The child's boat representing their life. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 19 of 25

The same Jesus who silenced the storm on Galilee can silence the storms in YOUR heart. Fear? *"Peace, be still!"* Worry? *"Peace, be still!"* Anxiety about tomorrow? *"Peace, be still!"* His voice still carries that same authority. When you invite Jesus into your situation — when you call on His name — He speaks peace into your chaos.

□ **PICTURE:** *A child with their eyes closed, hands over their heart, as Jesus' voice (shown as golden peaceful light) calms the storms of worry and fear around them. The chaos dissolving into peace. Words "Peace, be still" written in golden light. Transformation from turmoil to calm. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 20 of 25

Notice that Jesus didn't prevent the storm — He went through it WITH them. Sometimes God doesn't remove our difficulties, but He promises to be **with us in them**. The boat didn't sink because Jesus was in it! Your life won't be destroyed because Jesus is with you. The storm may rage, but you have the Storm-Calmer on board!

□ **PICTURE:** *A small boat in various types of storms — but always stable because a glowing figure (Jesus) is always aboard. Multiple scenes showing different storms of life but the boat always staying afloat. Safety in His presence. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 21 of 25

Jesus asked, *"Where is your faith?"* This is His question to us today too. Faith doesn't mean the storm won't come. Faith means knowing **WHO is in the boat with you**. Faith means trusting that the One who controls the wind and waves also controls your situation. Even when it looks impossible — God is still God!

□ **PICTURE:** *A child in bed at night during a thunderstorm outside the window. But instead of fear, the child is praying peacefully, a warm glow of faith around them. Jesus sitting on the edge of the bed, watching over them. Safety and trust despite the storm outside. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 22 of 25

The boat reached the other side safely — just as Jesus had said it would. When Jesus says *"Let us cross to the other side,"* He didn't say "Let us sink in the middle!" If God has a plan for your life — and He does! — then **no storm can stop His purpose**. You WILL reach the other side. The storm is just part of the journey, not the end of the story!

□ **PICTURE:** *The boat arriving safely at the calm shore on the other side of the lake. Disciples stepping out onto dry land with relief. Jesus stepping out first with a knowing smile. Sunrise on the horizon — new beginning. Calm*

water, peaceful shore. The storm completely behind them. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.

Scene 23 of 25 — Reflection | ባብዓርዓር

What storm are you facing today? Maybe school is hard, maybe you're worried about something, maybe your family is going through a tough time. Remember — Jesus is in your boat! He is never asleep to your needs. He has power over EVERY storm. Call out to Him, and He will answer. His peace is stronger than any wave, and His love will carry you safely to the other side!

🖼️ **PICTURE:** *A child standing at the shore looking out at a vast sea. Above the water, the journey from storm to calm is shown. Jesus' hand reaching down from heaven toward the child. A rainbow arching across the sky — promise of hope. Peaceful, encouraging, hopeful image. East African/Eritrean features. Watercolor children's Bible illustration.*

Scene 24 of 25 — ባብዓርዓር | In Tigrigna

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Scene 25 of 25 — Moral Lesson | 00000

□ **Moral Lesson** | □□□□□ □□□□

When Jesus is with you, no storm can destroy you! The disciples had the Creator of the universe in their boat, yet they panicked! When life's storms come — fear, problems, hard times — remember WHO is with you. Jesus has authority over every storm. Call on Him and trust Him. He may not prevent the storm, but He will ALWAYS be with you through it. His "Peace, be still!" is for YOUR heart too!

Key Virtues: Faith, Trust in God, Peace, Courage, Calling on Jesus, Authority of Christ, Hope in Trials

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📖 Thank You for Reading!

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These stories were written with love to plant seeds of faith in children's hearts. Share them, read them aloud, and may God bless every child who hears them.

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"Train up a child in the way he should go; even when he is old he will not depart from it."

— **Proverbs 22:6** | 📖📖 22:6

Volume 1 — Stories 1-10 | More stories coming in Volume 2!